

THE TETRAHEDRAL HORN PROBLEM AND ASYMPTOTICS OF $U(N)$ $6J$ SYMBOLS

ABSTRACT. Horn's problem is concerned with characterizing the eigenvalues (a, b, c) of a Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) satisfying the constraint $A + B = C$ and has deep connections to tensor product invariants, Littlewood-Richardson coefficients, geometric invariant theory and the intersection theory of Schubert varieties. This paper concerns a generalization of Horn's problem we call the *tetrahedral Horn problem* that aims to characterize the tuples of eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) forming the edges of a tetrahedron in the space of Hermitian matrices and thus satisfying the constraints $A + B = C$, $B + D = F$, $D + C = E$ and $A + F = E$. We derive new inequalities satisfied by the Schur-polynomials of such eigenvalues and, using eigenvalue estimation techniques from quantum information theory, prove their satisfaction up to degree k implies the existence of approximate solutions with error $O(\sqrt{\frac{\log k}{k}})$. Moreover, the existence of such a matrices is connected to the semiclassical asymptotics of the $6j$ -symbols for the unitary group $U(n)$, which are maps between multiplicity spaces which encode the associativity constraint $(V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta) \otimes V_\delta \cong V_\alpha \otimes (V_\beta \otimes V_\delta)$ for unitary irreducible representations. Using our techniques, we prove the decay rate of the norms of such $6j$ -symbols is either inverse-polynomial or exponential depending on whether there exists such tetrahedra of Hermitian matrices.

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Date: September 2, 2025.

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1. INTRODUCTION

Denote by

$$(1) \quad \text{eig} : \mathcal{H}_n = \{A \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}); A^\dagger = A\} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_{\text{ord}}^n = \{(a_1 \geq a_2 \cdots \geq a_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n\}$$

the map assigning to a Hermitian matrix the set of its ordered eigenvalues. For $a \in \mathbb{R}_{\text{ord}}^n$, it is convenient to use notation $\text{Tr}[a] = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i$, where $\text{Tr}[a]$ coincides with the trace of a diagonal matrix with eigenvalues a_i .

The Horn problem is a classical Linear Algebra problem asking to determine the set

$$(2) \quad \text{Horn}(n) := \left\{ (a, b, c) \in (\mathbb{R}_{\text{ord}}^n)^3 \left| \begin{array}{l} \exists (A, B, C) \in (\mathcal{H}_n)^3, \\ \text{eig}(A) = a, \text{eig}(B) = b, \text{eig}(C) = c, \\ A + B = C \end{array} \right. \right\}.$$

The necessary and sufficient conditions for $(a, b, c) \in \text{Horn}(n)$ consists of the trace equality

$$(3) \quad \text{Tr}[c] = \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b],$$

and of a system of linear inequalities on (a, b, c) . These inequalities were first conjectured by Horn [Hor62], and they were established by Klyachko [Kly98], and by Knutson-Tao [KT99]. In the case of $n = 2$, the Horn problem reduces to the question of existence of triangles with given length sides in $\mathbb{R}^3$, and Horn inequalities reduce to triangle inequalities.

The fact that Horn inequalities are linear in (a, b, c) has several explanations stemming from different fields in Mathematics. One approach is as follows: for fixed (a, b) , the possible values of c such that $(a, b, c) \in \text{Horn}(n)$ form a convex polytope, and this follows from the Kirwan Convexity Theorem in symplectic geometry [kirwan???]. Another approach [APS17] is by relating the Horn problem to a similar problem for weighted planar network, in which case the counterpart of the eigenvalue map is piece-wise linear. Yet another approach is through representation theory of the group $U(n)$ **to complete**.

In this paper, we consider the following generalization of the set $\text{Horn}(n)$:

$$(4) \quad \text{Tetra}(n) := \left\{ (a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_{\text{ord}}^n)^6 \left| \begin{array}{l} \exists (A, B, C, D, E, F) \in (\mathcal{H}_n)^6, \\ \text{eig}(A) = a, \text{eig}(B) = b, \text{eig}(C) = c, \\ \text{eig}(D) = d, \text{eig}(E) = e, \text{eig}(F) = f, \\ A + B = C, B + D = F, C + D = E, A + F = E \end{array} \right. \right\}.$$

We say that 6-tuples $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \text{Tetra}(n)$ are tetrahedral, and we refer to the problem of determining $\text{Tetra}(n)$ as the tetrahedral Horn problem. This name is motivated by the fact that for $n = 2$ the set $\text{Tetra}(2)$ is closely related to the set of tetrahedra in $\mathbb{R}^3$. The tetrahedral Horn problem was stated in [CŞW18] (see Section 6, Problem 8) motivated by the quantum marginal problem in quantum information theory (**is it true?**).

As for the Horn problem, there are necessary trace conditions for the tetrahedral Horn problem:

$$(5) \quad \text{Tr}[c] = \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b], \quad \text{Tr}[e] = \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d], \quad \text{Tr}[f] = \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d].$$

Denote by $\mathcal{H}_n^+ \subset \mathcal{H}_n$ the set of non-negative Hermitian matrices, and by $\mathbb{R}_+^n = \{a \in \mathbb{R}_{\text{ord}}^n; a_n \geq 0\}$ the corresponding set of non-negative ordered tuples of non-negative real numbers. One can then define

$$(6) \quad \text{Tetra}^+(n) := \{(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^6 \cap \text{Tetra}(n)\}.$$

Without loss of generality, the tetrahedral Horn problem can be reduced to the problem of characterizing $\text{Tetra}^+(n)$. The reason for this is because $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \text{Tetra}(n)$ if and only if $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f}) \in \text{Tetra}^+(n)$ where $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f})$ is obtained by a shifting of the components of (a, b, c, d, e, f) by particular positive real numbers (for more details see Corollary 28 in Appendix A).

Besides the trace conditions, other necessary conditions for the tetrahedral Horn problem are available in literature. First, observe that the ordinary Horn inequalities apply to triples (a, b, c) , (b, d, f) , (a, f, e) , (c, d, e) . In addition to these linear inequalities, there are many non-linear ones, see *e.g.* [BS15; TCL11; Sag13; BGS08; FG13; LS14; Sra], [NS23, Section 6.2], [Sch52], [SJS18, Equation 5.2]. The non-linear inequalities are needed in the description of the set $\text{Tetra}^+(n)$ since this set is not a polyhedral cone (in contrast to the set $\text{Horn}(n)$). We illustrate this fact by the Figure 1 depicts a three-dimensional slice of the space $\text{Tetra}^+(2)$ for fixed values of a, b, d .

In order to describe our main results, we will need the following notation. For $a \in \mathbb{R}_+^n$, we denote by $O_a = \{A \in \mathcal{H}_n^+; \text{eig}(A) = a\}$ the set of non-negative Hermitian matrices with eigenvalues a . We denote by $\Lambda_+^* = \{(\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_n); \lambda_i \in \mathbb{Z}\}$ the set of dominant weights for $G = U(n)$, and by $\Lambda_{++}^* = \{\lambda \in \Lambda_+^*; \lambda_n \geq 0\}$ the set of positive dominant weights. The irreducible representations π_λ corresponding to positive weights are polynomial, and they extend to the matrix algebra $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$. For $\lambda \in \Lambda_{++}^*$, we denote by $|\lambda| = \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i$, and by H_λ the dimension of the representation for the symmetric group $S_{|\lambda|}$ associated to λ by the Schur-Weyl duality. It will be convenient to use rescaled characters of representations

$$(7) \quad \varphi_\lambda(X) = \frac{1}{H_\lambda} \chi_\lambda(X)$$

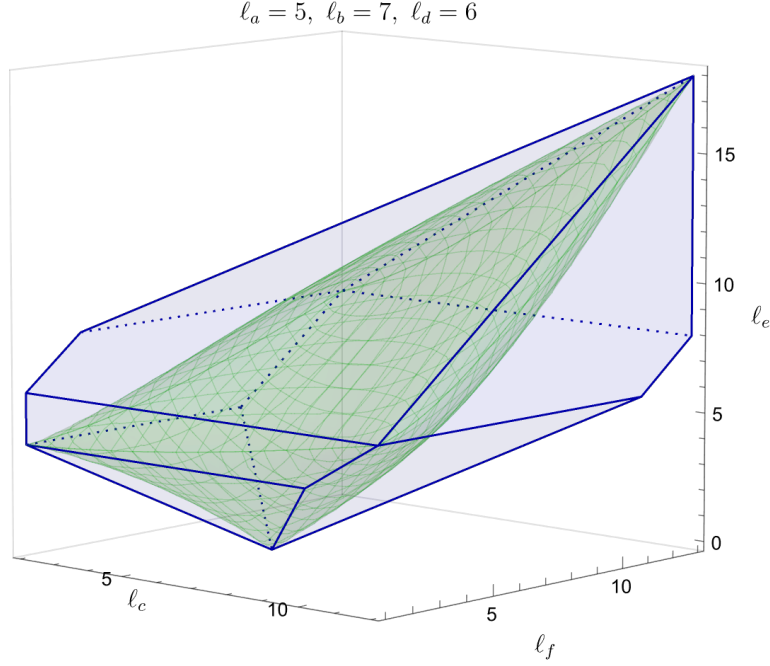


FIGURE 1. A comparison between the values for (ℓ_c, ℓ_e, ℓ_f) with fixed $(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_d) = (5, 7, 6)$ which merely satisfy the triangle inequalities (exterior blue polytope) and those which additionally satisfy the Cayley-Menger determinant inequality (interior green). The interior green region depicts (a slice of) the space of Euclidean tetrahedra with side lengths $(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f)$ and thus depicts the solution to the tetrahedral Horn problem for 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrices; remark that it is neither a polytope nor convex.

extended to $X \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$. Irreducible representations V_λ of $U(n)$ are equipped with Hermitian structures, and the decomposition of their tensor products

$$(8) \quad V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta = \oplus_\gamma C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \otimes V_\gamma$$

induces Hermitian structures of multiplicity spaces $C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$. The isomorphism between triple tensor products

$$(9) \quad (V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta) \otimes V_\delta \cong V_\alpha \otimes (V_\beta \otimes V_\delta)$$

induces maps

$$(10) \quad \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} : C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \otimes C_{\gamma\delta}^\epsilon \rightarrow C_{\alpha\phi}^\epsilon \otimes C_{\beta\delta}^\phi$$

called Wigner's 6j-symbols.

Our first result is a necessary and sufficient condition for tetrahedral 6-tuples:

thm:tet_iff_intro

Theorem 1. *Let $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^6$ be a 6-tuple satisfying the trace conditions. Then (a, b, c, d, e, f) is tetrahedral if and only if for all triples of positive weights $(\alpha, \beta, \delta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^3$ the following inequalities are satisfied*

{eq:tet_iff_intro}

$$(11) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)\varphi_\delta(d) \leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty (\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\delta(d)\varphi_\phi(f)\varphi_\gamma(c)\varphi_\epsilon(e))^{\frac{1}{3}}.$$

Furthermore, if inequalities ?? hold true for all triples $(\alpha, \beta, \delta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^3$ with $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = k$, then

$$(12) \quad \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]} D \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} \leq 36n(n+1) \sqrt{\frac{\log(k+1)}{k}},$$

where

$$(13) \quad D \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} := \min_{\substack{(A,B,D) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b \times \mathcal{O}_d}} \left(\|\text{eig}(A+B) - c\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(B+D) - f\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(A+B+D) - e\|_1^2 \right).$$

Note that in Eq. (11) the sum over γ, ϵ, f on the right hand side is finite since there is only a finite number of triples (γ, ϵ, f) for which the 6j-symbol is nonvanishing. Theorem 1 establishes an infinite set of polynomial (up to taking power 1/3) inequalities which characterize the set $\text{Tetra}^+(n)$. To the best of our knowledge, this the first system of polynomial inequalities which provides not only necessary but also sufficient conditions for $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \text{Tetra}^+(n)$. Furthermore, for each integer k we provide a finite set of inequalities, and the set defined by these inequalities is getting arbitrarily close to $\text{Tetra}^+(n)$ with the increase of k .

Our second result concerns the behavior of 6j-symbols for $G = U(n)$ for increasing weights:

thm:6j_estimates

Theorem 2. *Let $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in \text{Tetra}^+(n)$. Then, there is a sequence of 6-tuples of positive weights $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^6$ with $|\epsilon_k| = k$ such that*

$$(14) \quad \frac{1}{k}(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k) \xrightarrow{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]}(a, b, c, d, e, f),$$

and

{eq:n_independent_inverse_poly}

$$(15) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty \geq \frac{1}{(k+1)^{6 \text{rank}[e]}},$$

Furthermore, if $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \notin \text{Tetra}^+(n)$, then for any sequence $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^6$ converging to (a, b, c, d, e, f) we have for all sufficiently large k , the bound

$$(16) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty \leq C e^{-kr}$$

for some $C, r > 0$.

Theorem 2 is an instance of a correspondence between geometry and representation theory. Indeed, the asymptotic behavior of representation theoretic objects (6j-symbols) is controlled by solutions of a geometric problem (the tetrahedral Horn problem). The statement of Theorem 2 should be compared with a similar statement available for $G = SU(2)$, see [Rob99]. There, the exponential decay statement is similar to our statement, but the polynomial bound statement is more precise with the sequence

$$(17) \quad (\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k) = k(\alpha_1, \beta_1, \gamma_1, \delta_1, \epsilon_1, \phi_1).$$

While being a weaker statement for $G = SU(2)$, Theorem 2 applies to all n . Implicitly, Theorem 2 is contained in [CŞW18]. In this paper, we give a direct proof.

The methods used in the proofs include the Schur-Weyl duality and the non-commutative binomial formula based on it. These features distinguish the case of $G = U(n)$ discussed in this paper and versions of the tetrahedral Horn problem that one may define for other compact groups. Another key observation used in the proofs is the eigenvalue estimation which shows the positive functions $\lambda \mapsto \varphi_\lambda(x)$ are small outside the region where λ is proportional to x . This observation together with Theorem 2 explain the meaning of mysterious inequalities in Eq. (11) in Theorem 1. Indeed, by choosing (α, β, δ) such that $\alpha \sim a, \beta \sim b, \delta \sim d$ we maximize the left hand side. The choice of (γ, ϵ, ϕ) with $\gamma \sim c, \epsilon \sim e, \phi \sim f$ maximizes the second factor on the right hand side. If the 6-tuple (a, b, c, d, e, f) is not tetrahedral, the 6j-symbol is exponentially decaying, and Eq. (11) is unlikely to hold for all k .

Acknowledgments. TCF thanks Suvrit Sra, Harold Nieuwboer, Marco Fanizza and Jack Davis for helpful discussions. MC and TCF acknowledge financial support from the European Research Council (ERC Grant Agreement No. 818761), VILLUM FONDEN via the QMATH Centre of Excellence (Grant No. 10059) and the Novo Nordisk Foundation (grant NNF20OC0059939 ‘Quantum for Life’). They also thank the National Center for Competence in Research SwissMAP of the Swiss National Science Foundation and the Section of Mathematics at the University of Geneva for their hospitality.

2. BACKGROUND MATERIAL

[sec:background](#)

In Section 2.1, we review material on the representation theory of compact connected Lie groups, specifically the group $U(n)$, and in Section 2.2 we review some measure theory associated to Haar integrals of such groups. Along the way, we introduce a series of the polynomial functions $\varphi_\lambda(X)$, $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ and $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ of one, two and three $n \times n$ matrices respectively, and provide a formula for the representation of a matrix sum $X + Y$ which we refer to as the binomial theorem.

[sec:background_rep_theory](#)

2.1. Representation theory. Even though we will primarily deal with $G = U(n)$, we start with a more general story.

2.1.1. G compact. Let G be a compact connected Lie group, $T \subset G$ a maximal torus, $\mathfrak{t} = \text{Lie}(T)$ its Lie algebra, $\Lambda = \ker(\exp) \subset \mathfrak{t}$ the integral lattice, $\Lambda^* \subset \mathfrak{t}^*$ the weight lattice, and $\Lambda_+^* \subset \Lambda^*$ the set of dominant weights of G . For $\lambda \in \Lambda^*$, we denote by $\pi_\lambda : G \rightarrow \text{End}(V_\lambda)$ the corresponding irreducible representation of G . We will always assume that the space V_λ is equipped with an invariant Hermitian structure such that π_λ becomes a unitary representation. All representations π_λ extend to the corresponding complex Lie group $G^\mathbb{C}$.

The tensor product of two irreducible representations admits a unique decomposition of the form

[{eq:tensor_product}](#)

$$(18) \quad V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta = \bigoplus_{\gamma} C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \otimes V_\gamma,$$

where $C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$ are multiplicity spaces with dimensions $c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma = \dim C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$. Hermitian structures on V_λ 's induces Hermitian structures on the multiplicity spaces $C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$. In particular, the decomposition in Eq. (18) is an orthogonal decomposition. We let $\iota_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma : C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \otimes V_\gamma \rightarrow V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta$ denote the corresponding isometry and $\Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma = \iota_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma\dagger}$ the corresponding orthogonal projection operator. Using this notation, we have for all $g \in G$

[{eq:operator_product}](#)

$$(19) \quad \pi_\alpha(g) \otimes \pi_\beta(g) = \sum_{\gamma} \iota_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma (\text{id}_{C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma} \otimes \pi_\gamma(g)) \iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma\dagger},$$

Characters of irreducible representations are denoted by

[{eq:character}](#)

$$(20) \quad \chi_\lambda(g) = \text{Tr}_{V_\lambda}[\pi_\lambda(g)].$$

Taking a trace of Eq. (19) we obtain the standard product rule for characters:

[{eq:product_rule}](#)

$$(21) \quad \chi_\alpha(g) \chi_\beta(g) = \sum_{\gamma} c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \chi_\gamma(g).$$

Triple tensor products can be decomposed in two alternative ways:

$$(22) \quad \begin{aligned} (V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta) \otimes V_\delta &= \bigoplus_{\gamma, \epsilon} (C_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \otimes C_{\gamma\delta}^\epsilon) \otimes V_\epsilon, \\ V_\alpha \otimes (V_\beta \otimes V_\delta) &= \bigoplus_{\phi, \epsilon} (C_{\alpha\phi}^\epsilon \otimes C_{\beta\delta}^\phi) \otimes V_\epsilon. \end{aligned}$$

We will denote the corresponding orthogonal projectors by $P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma}$ and $Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}$, respectively (the letters γ and ϕ will always be associated to these decompositions):

`{eq:double_projs}`
(23)

$$\begin{aligned} P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} &:= \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon}(\Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\delta}^n}) = (\iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\delta}^n})(\Pi_{\gamma\delta}^{\epsilon} \otimes \text{id}_{C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}})(\iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\delta}^n})^{\dagger}, \\ Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} &:= \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon}(\text{id}_{V_{\alpha}^n} \otimes \Pi_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}) = (\text{id}_{V_{\alpha}^n} \otimes \iota_{\beta\delta}^{\phi})(\Pi_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon} \otimes \text{id}_{C_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}})(\text{id}_{V_{\alpha}^n} \otimes \iota_{\beta\delta}^{\phi})^{\dagger}. \end{aligned}$$

For fixed α, β, δ and γ, ϕ, ϵ , consider the composition of these two projectors $P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma}$ and $Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}$. This composition induces a G -equivariant linear map of the type

$$(24) \quad (C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes C_{\gamma\delta}^{\epsilon}) \otimes V_{\epsilon} \rightarrow (C_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon} \otimes C_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}) \otimes V_{\epsilon}.$$

Since π_{ϵ} is an irreducible representation, by Schur's Lemma this map is a tensor product of the identity on V_{ϵ} , and a map

$$(25) \quad \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} : C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes C_{\gamma\delta}^{\epsilon} \rightarrow C_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon} \otimes C_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}$$

called the $6j$ -symbol for G . Concretely, we will define $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ by the for-

`{eq:sym}`
(26)

$$\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} := \frac{1}{\dim(V_{\epsilon})} \text{Tr}_{V_{\epsilon}}[(\iota_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon} \otimes \text{id}_{C_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}})^{\dagger}(\text{id}_{V_{\alpha}^n} \otimes \iota_{\beta\delta}^{\phi})^{\dagger}(\iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\delta}^n})(\text{id}_{C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}} \otimes \iota_{\gamma\delta}^{\epsilon})],$$

`{eq:prod_proj}` which ensures

(27)

$$P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} = (\text{id}_{V_{\alpha}^n} \otimes \iota_{\beta\delta}^{\phi})(\iota_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon} \otimes \text{id}_{C_{\beta\delta}^{\phi}})(\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} \otimes V_{\epsilon}^n)(\text{id}_{C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}} \otimes \iota_{\gamma\delta}^{\epsilon})^{\dagger}(\iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\delta}^n})^{\dagger}.$$

Recall that for Hermitian vector spaces V_1, V_2 and an operator $O : V_1 \rightarrow V_2$ one can introduce the norms

$$(28) \quad \begin{aligned} \|O\|_{\infty} &= \max_{v \in V_1, \|v\|_{V_1}=1} \|O(v)\|_{V_2}, \\ \|O\|_2 &= \text{Tr}_{V_1}[O^{\dagger}O]^{\frac{1}{2}} = \text{Tr}_{V_2}[OO^{\dagger}]^{\frac{1}{2}}, \end{aligned}$$

which satisfy the following estimates:

`{eq:norm_estimates}`

$$(29) \quad \|O\|_{\infty}^2 \leq \|O\|_2^2 \leq \dim(V_1) \|O\|_{\infty}^2.$$

2.1.2. $G = U(n)$ and functions φ_{λ} . For $G = U(n)$, dominant weights are parametrized by non-increasing arrays of integers, $\lambda = (\lambda_1 \geq \lambda_2 \geq \dots \geq \lambda_n)$, where $\lambda_i \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $\lambda_i \geq \lambda_{i+1}$ for all i . In particular, the first fundamental weight $\varpi_1 = (1, 0, \dots, 0)$ corresponds to the defining representation of $U(n)$ on $V_{\varpi_1} = \mathbb{C}^n$.

We say that a dominant weight λ is positive if each of its components is positive (i.e., $\lambda_n \geq 0$), and we denote the set of positive weights by Λ_{++}^* .

For positive weights, we let

$$(30) \quad |\lambda| := \sum_{i=1}^n \lambda_i, \quad \ell(\lambda) := |\{i; \lambda_i \neq 0\}|,$$

where $|\lambda|$ is called the size of λ and $\ell(\lambda)$ is called the depth of λ . Henceforth we use the notation $\lambda \vdash_n k$ to denote the set of positive weights with size k and length at most n , and $\lambda \vdash k$ to denote the set of positive weights with size k and arbitrary length. Positive weights λ are then equivalent to integer partitions of $|\lambda|$ into $\ell(\lambda) \leq n$ parts, or as Young diagrams with $|\lambda|$ boxes and at most $\ell(\lambda)$ rows. Representations $\pi_\lambda(g)$ corresponding to positive weights are polynomial in matrix elements of g , and thus they extend to matrix algebras $\text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$. That is,

$$(31) \quad \pi_\lambda(X)\pi_\lambda(Y) = \pi_\lambda(XY)$$

for all $X, Y \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$. If X is a Hermitian matrix with eigenvalues $x = (x_1 \geq \dots \geq x_n)$ then the character of X for the representation π_λ , denoted by $\chi_\lambda(X)$, is equal to the Schur-polynomial of its eigenvalues x , denoted by $s_\lambda(x)$. Moreover, the dimension for the irreducible representation V_λ is given by Weyl's dimension formula for $U(n)$ [Hal08; IN66],

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:weyl_dim\}}} \quad (32) \quad \dim(V_\lambda^n) = \frac{\prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq n} (\lambda_i - i - \lambda_j + j)}{\prod_{1 \leq i < j \leq n} (j - i)}.$$

Tensor products of representations with positive weights decompose into direct sums of representations of the same type. Note that in the decomposition of the tensor product representation $V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta$ appearing in Eq. (18), the only positive weights $|\gamma|$ which appear are those which satisfy the size condition

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:size_condition_tri\}}} \quad (33) \quad |\gamma| = |\alpha| + |\beta|.$$

Recall that for Young diagrams (or partitions) λ with fixed size $|\lambda| = k$ label isomorphism classes of irreducible representations W_λ of the symmetric group S_k . The dimensions of these representations are given by the formula

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:dim_W_hook_product\}}} \quad (34) \quad \dim(W_\lambda) = \frac{|\lambda|!}{H_\lambda}, \quad H_\lambda = \prod_{b \in \lambda} h_\lambda(b),$$

where $h_\lambda(b)$ is the hook length of box b and is defined as the number of boxes to the right and below b in λ plus one for itself, and H_λ is referred to as the hook product of λ . For the future use, we introduce rescaled representations

$$(35) \quad \Phi_\lambda(X) = \frac{1}{H_\lambda} \pi_\lambda(X),$$

and rescaled characters

$$(36) \quad \varphi_\lambda(X) = \text{Tr}_{V_\lambda} \Phi_\lambda(X) = \frac{1}{H_\lambda} \chi_\lambda(X).$$

Note that

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:varphi_normalization\}}} \quad (37) \quad \sum_{\lambda \vdash k} \varphi_\lambda(X) = \frac{[\text{Tr}(X)]^k}{k!}, \quad \text{and} \quad \sum_{\lambda} \varphi_\lambda(X) = \exp(\text{Tr}(X)).$$

Indeed, by the Schur-Weyl duality, there is an isomorphism of $(S_k \otimes U(n))$ -modules

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:schur-weyl\}}} \quad (38) \quad (\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k} \cong \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash_n k} W_\lambda \otimes V_\lambda,$$

where the symmetric group S_k acts by permutations of tensor factors in $(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}$. For each λ , we let

$$(39) \quad \iota_\lambda : W_\lambda \otimes V_\lambda^n \rightarrow (\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k},$$

denote the unique isometric $S_k \times U(n)$ -equivariant map from $W_\lambda \otimes V_\lambda^n$ to $(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}$. Since all $U(n)$ representations entering the decomposition in Eq. (38) are positive, the Schur-Weyl duality extends to an isomorphism of modules for monoids $(S_k \otimes \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}))$. Applying it to an element $X \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$, we obtain

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:X^k\}}} \quad (40) \quad X^{\otimes k} = \bigoplus_{\lambda \vdash_n k} \iota_\lambda(\text{id}_{W_\lambda} \otimes \pi_\lambda(X)) \iota_\lambda^\dagger,$$

Taking a trace of this equation over $(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}$ yields Eq. (37).

Henceforth we denote the space of Hermitian matrices of size n by $\mathcal{H}_n$ and the space of positive-semidefinite Hermitian matrices by $\mathcal{H}_n^+$. Given a Hermitian matrix $X \in \mathcal{H}_n$, $\text{eig}(X)$ denotes the eigenvalues of X .

Proposition 3. *For $X \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$, $\lambda \in \Lambda_{++}^*$, operators $\pi_\lambda(X)$ and $\Phi_\lambda(X)$ are non-negative Hermitian operators, and functions $\varphi_\lambda(X)$ take non-negative real values on $\mathcal{H}_n^+$.*

Proof. By Eq. (40), operators $\text{id}_{W_\lambda} \otimes \pi_\lambda(X)$ are orthogonal restrictions of the non-negative Hermitian operator $X^{\otimes k}$. Hence, they are also non-negative Hermitian operators, and so are $\pi_\lambda(X)$ and $\Phi_\lambda(X)$. Since $\varphi_\lambda(X)$ is the trace of $\Phi_\lambda(X)$, it takes values in $\mathbb{R}_{\geq 0}$. $\square$

2.1.3. *The function $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}$ and the binomial theorem.* It is convenient to introduce the following functions of two matrices,

$$(41) \quad \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) = \text{Tr}_{V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta}(\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y)) \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma.$$

Proposition 4. *For $\alpha, \beta \in \Lambda_{++}^*$ and $X, Y \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$, we have*

$$\text{\texttt{\{eq:varphi_product_sum\}}} \quad (42) \quad \varphi_\alpha(X) \varphi_\beta(Y) = \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y).$$

For $X, Y \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$, the function $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ takes non-negative real values.

Proof. For the first statement, note that

$$(43) \quad \sum_{\gamma} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = \text{id}_{V_{\alpha}} \otimes \text{id}_{V_{\beta}},$$

which then implies

$$(44) \quad \begin{aligned} \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) &= \sum_{\gamma} \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta}}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\alpha}(Y)) \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}, \\ &= \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta}}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\alpha}(Y)), \\ &= \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\beta}(Y). \end{aligned}$$

For the second statement, we have

$$(45) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) &= \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta}}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\alpha}(Y)) \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}, \\ &= \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta}} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\alpha}(Y)) \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}. \end{aligned}$$

Hence, $\varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ is the trace of the orthogonal restriction of the non-negative Hermitian operator $(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\alpha}(Y))$ to the subspace $(C_{\alpha\beta} \otimes V_{\gamma}) \subseteq V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta}$, meaning $\varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) \geq 0$ as claimed. $\square$

thm:the_binomial_theorem

Theorem 5 (Binomial theorem). *For $X, Y \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$ and $\gamma \in \Lambda_{++}^*$, we have*

{eq:varphi_sum_sum}

$$(46) \quad \varphi_{\gamma}(X + Y) = \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y).$$

Proof. Let $k = |\gamma|$ and let ρ_k denote the representation of the monoid $(S_k \times \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C}))$ on the space $(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}$, and $\Pi^{\gamma} = \iota_{\gamma} \iota_{\gamma}^{\dagger}$ the orthogonal projector to the summand $W_{\gamma} \otimes V_{\gamma}$ in the Schur-Weyl decomposition Eq. (38). Recall that $\dim(W_{\lambda}) = |\lambda|! / H_{\lambda}$. Then we have for all k and $X \in \text{Mat}_n(\mathbb{C})$,

$$(47) \quad \begin{aligned} \text{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}}[\Pi_{\lambda} \rho_k(X)] &= \text{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}}[\Pi_{\lambda} X^{\otimes k}] \\ &= \dim(W_{\lambda}) \text{Tr}_{V_{\lambda}}[\pi_{\lambda}(X)] = k! \varphi_{\lambda}(X). \end{aligned}$$

Moreover, we have

$$(48) \quad (X + Y)^{\otimes k} = \sum_{l=0}^k \frac{1}{l!(k-l)!} \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \rho_k(\sigma)(X^{\otimes l} \otimes Y^{\otimes(k-l)}) \rho_k(\sigma^{-1})$$

which is a non-commutative counterpart of the binomial decomposition. We compute

$$\begin{aligned}
 (49) \quad & \varphi_\gamma(X + Y) \\
 &= \frac{1}{k!} \operatorname{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}} \Pi^\gamma(X + Y)^{\otimes k}, \\
 &= \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{l=0}^k \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \frac{1}{l!(k-l)!} \operatorname{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}} \Pi^\gamma \rho_k(\sigma)(X^{\otimes l} \otimes Y^{\otimes(k-l)}) \rho_k(\sigma^{-1}), \\
 &= \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{l=0}^k \sum_{\sigma \in S_k} \frac{1}{l!(k-l)!} \operatorname{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}} \Pi^\gamma(X^{\otimes l} \otimes Y^{\otimes(k-l)}), \\
 &= \sum_{l=0}^k \frac{1}{l!(k-l)!} \sum_{\substack{\alpha \vdash l \\ \beta \vdash k-l}} \operatorname{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}} \Pi^\gamma(\Pi^\alpha X^{\otimes l} \otimes \Pi^\beta Y^{\otimes(k-l)}), \\
 &= \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \frac{1}{|\alpha|! |\beta|!} \operatorname{Tr}_{(\mathbb{C}^n)^{\otimes k}} \Pi^\gamma(\Pi^\alpha X^{\otimes l} \otimes \Pi^\beta Y^{\otimes(k-l)}), \\
 &= \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \frac{1}{H_\alpha H_\beta} \operatorname{Tr}_{V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma(\pi_\alpha(X) \otimes \pi_\beta(Y)), \\
 &= \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \operatorname{Tr}_{V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma(\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y)), \\
 &= \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \phi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma(X, Y).
 \end{aligned}$$

□

2.1.4. *The function $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}$.* For a 6-tuple of positive weights, we introduce a function of three matrices,

$$(50) \quad \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) := \operatorname{Tr}_{V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta \otimes V_\delta} P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon; \phi}(\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y) \otimes \Phi_\delta(Z)) Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon; \gamma}.$$

Note that the following size equalities are necessary conditions for $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$

being non-zero and thus $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}$ being non-zero:

`{eq:size_conditions_tet}`

$$(51) \quad |\alpha| + |\beta| = |\gamma|, \quad |\beta| + |\delta| = |\phi|, \quad |\alpha| + |\phi| = |\epsilon|, \quad |\gamma| + |\delta| = |\epsilon|.$$

Even when restricted to $(\mathcal{H}_n^+)^{\times 3}$, functions $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}$ take complex values, in general. However, the following is true:

prop:non_neg_partial

Proposition 6. *For $X, Y, Z \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$, the functions*

$$\begin{aligned}
 (52) \quad & \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) = \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z), \\
 & \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) = \sum_{\phi} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)
 \end{aligned}$$

take non-negative real values.

Proof. We compute,

$$\begin{aligned}
 (53) \quad \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &= \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z), \\
 &= \sum_{\gamma} \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta} \otimes V_{\delta}} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y) \otimes \Phi_{\delta}(Z)) P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma}, \\
 &= \text{Tr}_{V_{\alpha} \otimes V_{\beta} \otimes V_{\delta}} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y) \otimes \Phi_{\delta}(Z)).
 \end{aligned}$$

Here we have used the fact that $\sum_{\gamma} P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} = \Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon}$, where $\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon}$ is the orthogonal projector to the isotypical component of ϵ in the triple tensor product. We have also used the fact that $\Pi_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} = Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}$. The right hand side in the equation above is the trace of the orthogonal restriction of the non-negative Hermitian operator $(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y) \otimes \Phi_{\delta}(Z))$ to the image of the projector $Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}$. Hence, it is a non-negative real number. The proof for functions $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ is similar. $\square$

2.1.5. *Estimates for $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}$.* Here we derive bounds on the magnitude of $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$. To begin we need the following proposition.

prop:cauchy-schwarz-ineq-double-proj

Proposition 7. *Let P, Q be two orthogonal projections, and Ω be a non-negative Hermitian operator. Then,*

eq:cauchy-schwarz-ineq-double-proj}

$$(54) \quad |\text{Tr}(P\Omega Q)| \leq \|PQ\|_{\infty} (\text{Tr } P\Omega)^{\frac{1}{2}} (\text{Tr } \Omega Q)^{\frac{1}{2}}.$$

Proof. We compute,

$$\begin{aligned}
 (55) \quad |\text{Tr}(P\Omega Q)| &= |\text{Tr}(PQ\Omega P)|, \\
 &= |\text{Tr}(PQ\Omega^{\frac{1}{2}})(\Omega^{\frac{1}{2}}P)|, \\
 &\leq (\text{Tr } PQ\Omega QP)^{\frac{1}{2}} (\text{Tr } P\Omega P)^{\frac{1}{2}}, \\
 &= (\text{Tr } PQ\Omega QP)^{\frac{1}{2}} (\text{Tr } P\Omega)^{\frac{1}{2}},
 \end{aligned}$$

where in the third line we have used the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality for the Hilbert-Schmidt norm. Let $U = \text{im}(Q)$ and choose a basis of eigenvectors $\{e_j\}$ of the operator $Q\Omega Q$ with eigenvalues $\omega_j \geq 0$. Then,

$$\begin{aligned}
 (56) \quad \text{Tr}(PQ\Omega QP) &= \text{Tr}(QP^2Q)(Q\Omega Q), \\
 &= \sum_j \omega_j \|PQe_j\|^2, \\
 &\leq \|PQ\|_{\infty}^2 \text{Tr}(Q\Omega Q), \\
 &= \|PQ\|_{\infty}^2 \text{Tr}(\Omega Q).
 \end{aligned}$$

This completes the proof. $\square$

Applying this proposition to the definition of $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ we conclude the following.

prop:varphi_tet_main_ineq

Proposition 8. *Let $X, Y, Z \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$. Then,*

$$(57) \quad \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \right| \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)^{\frac{1}{2}} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)^{\frac{1}{2}}.$$

Proof. Let $\Omega_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{X,Y,Z} := \Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y) \otimes \Phi_{\delta}(Z) \geq 0$. Under the assumption that $X, Y, Z \geq 0$, we have that $\Omega_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{X,Y,Z} \geq 0$. Therefore, Proposition 7 implies

$$(58) \quad \left| \text{Tr}[P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} \Omega_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{X,Y,Z}] \right| \leq \left\| P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} \right\|_{\infty} \text{Tr}[P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma} \Omega_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{X,Y,Z}]^{\frac{1}{2}} \text{Tr}[Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} \Omega_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{X,Y,Z}]^{\frac{1}{2}}$$

which is equivalent to the claim due to Eq. (27). $\square$

Our next proposition enables us to place bounds on $\varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ and $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ which depend only the eigenvalues of $X, Y, X+Y, Z, X+Y+Z$, and $Y+Z$ and not their eigenvectors. These bounds, in conjunction with Proposition 8 will help us in the proof of Theorem 18 latter.

prop:tet_psum_ineq

Proposition 9. *Let $X, Y, Z \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$. Then,*

{eq:psum_prod_bounds}

$$(59) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\phi}(Y+Z), & \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\gamma}(X+Y) \varphi_{\delta}(Z), \\ \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\beta}(Y) \varphi_{\delta}(Z), & \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\beta}(Y) \varphi_{\delta}(Z), \\ \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\epsilon}(X+Y+Z), & \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &\leq \varphi_{\epsilon}(X+Y+Z). \end{aligned}$$

Proof. Each of these bounds are consequences of Theorem 5 and Proposition 6. Summing $\varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ over ϵ yields

{eq:psum_yf_over_ye}

$$(60) \quad \begin{aligned} \sum_{\epsilon} \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) &= \sum_{\epsilon} \text{Tr}[\Pi_{\alpha\phi}^{\epsilon}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\phi}^{\beta\delta}(Y, Z))], \\ &= \text{Tr}[\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\phi}^{\beta\delta}(Y, Z)], \\ &= \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\phi}^{\beta\delta}(Y, Z). \end{aligned}$$

Then, summing the result over β and δ and applying Theorem 5 produces

$$(61) \quad \sum_{\epsilon\beta\delta} \varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) = \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \sum_{\beta\delta} \varphi_{\phi}^{\beta\delta}(Y, Z) = \varphi_{\alpha}(X) \varphi_{\phi}(Y+Z).$$

Now using the non-negativity of $\varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$, we obtain the first claimed inequality in Eq. (59). Similarly, the second claimed inequality in Eq. (59) follows analogously from summing $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ over γ , and ϵ , while the third claimed inequality in Eq. (59) follows from summing $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon-}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ over γ, α, β and δ . The inequalities concerning $\varphi_{-\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ are proven in an analogous manner. $\square$

[sec:background_probability](#)

2.2. Probability measures. In this Section, we collect information about probability measures on finite sets and on conjugacy classes of Hermitian matrices needed later in the paper.

2.2.1. Measures on finite sets. Recall that for a finite set $[r] = \{1, \dots, r\}$ a probability measure is defined by an array of non-negative real numbers $(p_1, \dots, p_r)$ such that $\sum_{i=1}^r p_i = 1$. For two measures p and q on $[r]$, the Kolmogorov distance $K(p, q)$ between them is defined by:

$$(62) \quad K(p, q) := \frac{1}{2} \|p - q\|_1 = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{i=1}^r |p_i - q_i|.$$

Another measure of similarity between distributions p and q is the Bhattacharyya coefficient [\[Bha46; FV02\]](#):

[{eq:Bhattacharyya_coefficient}](#)

$$(63) \quad \text{BC}(p, q) = \sum_{i=1}^r \sqrt{p_i q_i}.$$

For all distributions p, q , the Bhattacharyya coefficient $\text{BC}(p, q)$ lies in the interval $[0, 1]$, and $\text{BC}(p, q) = 1$ if and only if $p = q$. Recall the following relation between the Kolmogorov distance and the Bhattacharyya coefficient (see *e.g.* [\[FV02, Proposition 5, Equation \(41\)\]](#)):

$$(64) \quad 1 - \text{BC}(p, q) \leq K(p, q) \leq \sqrt{1 - \text{BC}(p, q)^2}.$$

[{eq:BC_norm_estimate}](#) This implies¹

$$(65) \quad \text{BC}(p, q) \leq \sqrt{1 - K(p, q)^2} \leq \exp\left(-\frac{1}{2} K(p, q)^2\right) = \exp\left(-\frac{1}{8} \|p - q\|_1^2\right).$$

We extend the Bhattacharyya coefficient to non-normalized non-negative tuples with $\sum_i p_i = \sum_i q_i = \tau > 0$. In that case, the *unnormalized* Bhattacharyya coefficient is also denoted by

$$(66) \quad \text{BC}(p, q) = \tau B\left(\frac{p}{\tau}, \frac{q}{\tau}\right),$$

and the estimate in Eq. [\(65\)](#) then reads

[{eq:bhattacharyya_vs_distance}](#)

$$(67) \quad \frac{\text{BC}(p, q)}{\tau} \leq \exp\left(-\frac{1}{8\tau^2} \|p - q\|_1^2\right).$$

Finally, the Kullback-Leibler (KL) divergence is defined as

[{eq:KL_divergence}](#)

$$(68) \quad D(p\|q) = \sum_{i=1}^n p_i \log \frac{p_i}{q_i}.$$

It takes values between 0 and $+\infty$, and it is equal to zero if and only if $p = q$.

¹Here we used the inequality $\sqrt{1 - x^2} \leq \exp(-x^2/2)$ which holds for all $x \in [0, 1]$.

2.2.2. *Measures on partitions.* We define the set

$$(69) \quad \mathbb{R}_n^+ = \{x = (x_1 \geq x_2 \geq \cdots \geq x_n) \in \mathbb{R}^n; x \neq 0, x_n \geq 0\}.$$

One can associate to $x \in \mathbb{R}_n^+$ a probability measure p^x on the set $[n]$ by assigning

$$(70) \quad p_i^x = \frac{x_i}{|x|}, \quad \text{where} \quad |x| = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i.$$

Let $X = \text{diag}(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ be a diagonal non-negative Hermitian matrix with x_i 's on the diagonal. By abuse of notation, we write $\varphi_\lambda(x) = \varphi_\lambda(X)$. For each x and each $k \geq 1$, using Eq. (37), one can define a probability measure on the set of positive weights of $U(n)$ with size $|\lambda| = k$:

$$(71) \quad P_x(\lambda) := \frac{k!}{|x|^k} \varphi_\lambda(x) = \frac{\text{Tr}[\Pi_\lambda X^{\otimes k}]}{\text{Tr}[X^{\otimes k}]}.$$

This probability distribution is known as the *Schur-Weyl* distribution for x of degree $k = |\lambda|$ [OW16]. A key property of the Schur-Weyl distribution $P_x(\lambda)$ is that it behaves similarly to the multinomial distribution $m_x(\lambda)$ where

$$(72) \quad m_x(\lambda) := \frac{|\lambda|!}{\text{Tr}[x]^k} \frac{x_1^{\lambda_1}}{\lambda_1!} \frac{x_2^{\lambda_2}}{\lambda_2!} \cdots \frac{x_n^{\lambda_n}}{\lambda_n!}. \quad \text{prop:multinomial_bound}$$

Proposition 10. *Given a Young diagram λ and non-negative eigenvalues x ,*

$$(73) \quad P_x(\lambda) \leq \dim V_\lambda^n m_x(\lambda).$$

Proof. The proof follows from (i) an upper bound on the Schur-polynomial $s_\lambda(x)$,

$$(74) \quad s_\lambda(x) \leq \dim V_\lambda^n x_1^{\lambda_1} x_2^{\lambda_2} \cdots x_n^{\lambda_n},$$

which follows because $s_\lambda(x)$ can be expressed as a sum over $\dim V_\lambda^n$ multinomials of the form $x_1^{\mu_1} x_2^{\mu_2} \cdots x_n^{\mu_n}$ with $x_1^{\lambda_1} x_2^{\lambda_2} \cdots x_n^{\lambda_n}$ the largest, and (ii) a lower bound on the Hook-product,

$$(75) \quad H_\lambda \geq \lambda_1! \cdots \lambda_n!,$$

which follows because $h_\lambda(b) \geq \lambda_i - j + 1$ holds for the box b in row i and column j . $\square$

Remark 11. We will henceforth relax the dimension prefactor $\dim V_\lambda^n$ using the following dimension bound which holds for all Young diagrams with k boxes:

$$(76) \quad \dim V_\lambda^n \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} := (k+1)^{\frac{n(n-1)}{2}}.$$

The following is known result is known as eigenvalue or spectrum estimation [ARS88; KW01; HM02; CM06; OW16].

prop:eig_est

Proposition 12 (Eigenvalue estimation). *Let $x \in \mathbb{R}_+^n$, $\lambda \in \Lambda_{++}^*$ with $|\lambda| = k$. Then the Schur-Weyl distribution $P_x(\lambda)$ satisfies*

$$(77) \quad P_x(\lambda) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp\left(-kD\left(p^\lambda \parallel p^x\right)\right).$$

Proof. From Proposition 10 we have the bound $P_x(\lambda) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} m_x(\lambda)$. What remains is to bound the multinomial distribution $m_x(\lambda)$ using the Kullback-Leibler divergence. To this end, note that $k = |\lambda| = \lambda_1 + \dots + \delta_n$ which implies

$$(78) \quad \begin{aligned} m_x(\lambda) &= \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[x]^k} \frac{x_1^{\lambda_1}}{\lambda_1!} \dots \frac{x_n^{\lambda_n}}{\lambda_n!}, \\ &= \left(\frac{k!}{k^k} \frac{\lambda_1^{\lambda_1}}{\lambda_1!} \dots \frac{\lambda_n^{\lambda_n}}{\lambda_n!} \right) \left(\frac{k^k}{\text{Tr}[x]^k} \frac{x_1^{\lambda_1}}{\lambda_1^{\lambda_1}} \dots \frac{x_n^{\lambda_n}}{\lambda_n^{\lambda_n}} \right), \\ &= m_\lambda(\lambda) \exp \left[-k \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_i}{k} \log \left(\frac{\lambda_i}{k} \frac{\text{Tr}[x]}{x_i} \right) \right], \\ &= m_\lambda(\lambda) \exp \left[-kD\left(\frac{\lambda}{k} \parallel \frac{x}{\text{Tr}[x]}\right) \right]. \end{aligned}$$

Since $m_\lambda(\lambda) \in [0, 1]$ is a probability, we have the bound $m_\lambda(\lambda) \leq 1$ and therefore we obtain the claimed result:

$$(79) \quad P_x(\lambda) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} m_x(\lambda) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp \left[-kD\left(\frac{\lambda}{k} \parallel \frac{x}{\text{Tr}[x]}\right) \right].$$

□

In summary, the eigenvalue estimation result captures the fact that, like the multinomial distribution $m_x(\lambda)$, the Schur-Weyl distribution $P_x(\lambda)$ for large k is sharply concentrated around Young diagrams λ whose distribution, $p^\lambda = \lambda/|\lambda|$, is similar to the eigenvalue distribution $p^x = x/\text{Tr}[x]$.

The following proposition compares Schur-Weyl measures P_x and P_y for different $x, y \in \mathbb{R}_n^+$.

lem:eig_sep

Lemma 13 (Eigenvalue separation). *Let $x, y \in \mathbb{R}_n^+$ satisfy $\tau = \text{Tr}[x] = \text{Tr}[y]$. For any non-negative integer $k \geq 1$,*

{eq:eig_sep}

$$(80) \quad \text{BC}(P_x, P_y) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \text{BC}(p^x, p^y)^k.$$

Proof. From Proposition 10 and Eq. (76), we have

$$(81) \quad \text{BC}(P_x, P_y) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \text{BC}_k(m_x, m_y).$$

where $\text{BC}_k(m_x, m_y)$ is the Bhattacharyya coefficient between the multinomial distributions m_x and m_y . Since Bhattacharyya coefficients are multiplicative with respect to multinomial distributions, i.e.,

$$(82) \quad \text{BC}_k(m_x, m_y) = \text{BC}(p^x, p^y)^k,$$

we conclude Eq. (80). □

In subsequent sections we will frequently use a *weaker* approximation which holds for all Young diagrams λ of size k :

$$(83) \quad \sqrt{P_x(\lambda)P_y(\lambda)} \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \text{BC}(p^x, p^y)^k,$$

which follows from Lemma 13 because $\sqrt{P_x(\lambda)P_y(\lambda)} \leq \text{BC}(P_x, P_y)$ by definition. Restating this bound in terms of $\varphi_\alpha(x) = \frac{\text{Tr}[x]^k}{k!} P_x(\lambda)$, we observe

$$(84) \quad \sqrt{\varphi_x(\lambda)\varphi_y(\lambda)} \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \frac{\text{BC}(x, y)^{|\lambda|}}{|\lambda|!},$$

where on the right-hand side we use the unnormalized Bhattacharyya coefficient for notational convenience.

2.2.3. Measures on conjugacy classes. For $x \in \mathbb{R}_+^n$, we define the conjugacy class $\mathcal{O}_x$ of the diagonal matrix $[x] = \text{diag}(x_1, \dots, x_n)$ under the action of the unitary group $U(n)$:

$$(85) \quad \mathcal{O}_x = \{X = U[x]U^{-1}; U \in U(n)\} \subset \mathcal{H}_n^+.$$

Each conjugacy class carries a unique $U(n)$ -invariant probability measure μ_x . This measure can be constructed as the pushforward of the probability Haar measure on $U(n)$. Also, conjugacy classes are isomorphic to coadjoint orbits of $U(n)$ and they carry canonical Duistermaat-Heckman measure proportional to μ_x . In what follows, we will need expectation values $\mathbb{E}_x$ on conjugacy classes $\mathcal{O}_x$ with respect to the measure μ_x , $\mathbb{E}_{x,y}$ on $\mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y$ with the measure $\mu_x \times \mu_y$, and $\mathbb{E}_{x,y,z}$ on $\mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y \times \mathcal{O}_z$ with the measure $\mu_x \times \mu_y \times \mu_z$. prop:estimate_E_x_y_z

Proposition 14. *We have,*

$$(86) \quad \begin{aligned} \mathbb{E}_x \Phi_\lambda(X) &= \frac{\varphi_\lambda(x)}{\dim V_\lambda} \text{id}_{V_\lambda}, \\ \mathbb{E}_{x,y} \frac{\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)}{\dim V_\gamma} &= c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \frac{\varphi_\alpha(x)}{\dim V_\alpha} \frac{\varphi_\beta(y)}{\dim V_\beta}, \\ \mathbb{E}_{x,y,z} \frac{\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)}{\dim V_\epsilon} &= \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \frac{\varphi_\alpha(x)}{\dim V_\alpha} \frac{\varphi_\beta(y)}{\dim V_\beta} \frac{\varphi_\delta(z)}{\dim V_\delta}. \end{aligned}$$

Proof. For the first equality, by Schur's Lemma we have

$$(87) \quad \mathbb{E}_x \Phi_\lambda(X) = \int_{\mathcal{O}_x} \Phi_\lambda(X) d\mu_x = c(x) \text{id}_{V_\lambda}$$

for some $c(x) \in \mathbb{C}$. By taking a trace of the equality above, we obtain

$$(88) \quad \varphi_\lambda(x) = c(x) \dim V_\lambda \Rightarrow c(x) = \frac{\varphi_\lambda(x)}{\dim V_\lambda},$$

as required. For the second equality, we compute

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbb{E}_{x,y} \frac{\varphi_{\gamma}^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)}{\dim V_{\gamma}} &= \frac{1}{\dim V_{\gamma}} \mathbb{E}_{x,y} \text{Tr}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y)) \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}, \\
 (89) \quad &= \frac{\varphi_{\alpha}(x)}{\dim V_{\alpha}} \frac{\varphi_{\beta}(y)}{\dim V_{\beta}} \frac{1}{\dim V_{\gamma}} \text{Tr} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}, \\
 &= c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \frac{\varphi_{\alpha}(x)}{\dim V_{\alpha}} \frac{\varphi_{\beta}(y)}{\dim V_{\beta}}.
 \end{aligned}$$

Finally, for the third equality we compute

$$\begin{aligned}
 \mathbb{E}_{x,y,z} \frac{\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)}{\dim V_{\epsilon}} &= \frac{1}{\dim V_{\epsilon}} \mathbb{E}_{x,y,z} \text{Tr} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi}(\Phi_{\alpha}(X) \otimes \Phi_{\beta}(Y) \otimes \Phi_{\delta}(Z)) P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma}, \\
 &= \frac{1}{\dim V_{\epsilon}} \frac{\varphi_{\alpha}(x)}{\dim V_{\alpha}} \frac{\varphi_{\beta}(y)}{\dim V_{\beta}} \frac{\varphi_{\delta}(z)}{\dim V_{\delta}} \text{Tr} Q_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\phi} P_{\alpha\beta\delta}^{\epsilon;\gamma}, \\
 &= \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \frac{\varphi_{\alpha}(x)}{\dim V_{\alpha}} \frac{\varphi_{\beta}(y)}{\dim V_{\beta}} \frac{\varphi_{\delta}(z)}{\dim V_{\delta}}.
 \end{aligned}$$

□

Note that even though functions $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z)$ are complex values, their expectation values are real and positive. We will not use Proposition 14 in subsequent proofs directly; rather we will use the following consequence of Proposition 14.

lem:estimate_E_x_y_z_bound

Lemma 15. For all $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^{\times 6}$ and all $(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}_n^+$,

$$(91) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \varphi_{\alpha}(x) \varphi_{\beta}(y) \varphi_{\delta}(z) \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \max_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y \times \mathcal{O}_z}} \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \right|.$$

Proof. By Proposition 14, we have

$$(92) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \varphi_{\alpha}(x) \varphi_{\beta}(y) \varphi_{\delta}(z) = \frac{\dim(V_{\alpha}^n \otimes V_{\beta}^n \otimes V_{\delta}^n)}{\dim(V_{\epsilon}^n)} \mathbb{E}_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y \times \mathcal{O}_z}} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z).$$

Then claim then follows from the bound

$$(93) \quad \mathbb{E}_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y \times \mathcal{O}_z}} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \leq \max_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y \times \mathcal{O}_z}} \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \right|,$$

along with the dimension estimates $\dim(V_{\lambda}^n) \leq (|\lambda| + 1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}}$ for $\lambda \in \{\alpha, \beta, \delta\}$ from Eq. (76) and $\dim(V_{\epsilon}^n) \geq 1$. □

3. INEQUALITIES FOR TETRAHEDRAL EIGENVALUES

In this Section, we state and prove one of the main results of this paper. To set up notation, we will be considering 6-tuples of non-negative arrays $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^6$ satisfying the trace conditions

$$(94) \quad \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b] = \text{Tr}[c], \quad \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d] = \text{Tr}[f], \quad \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d] = \text{Tr}[e].$$

On the space of such 6-tuples, we introduce a function

$$(95) \quad D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) := \min_{(A,B,D) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b \times \mathcal{O}_d} \left(\|\text{eig}(A+B) - c\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(B+D) - f\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(A+B+D) - e\|_1^2 \right).$$

Note that $D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) = 0$ if and only if there exists non-negative Hermitian matrices

`{eq:six_matrices}`

$$(96) \quad (A, B, C = A + B, D, E = A + B + C, F = B + D) \in (\mathcal{H}_n^+)^6$$

with ordered eigenvalues given by (a, b, c, d, e, f) . We will also need 6-tuples of positive highest weights

$$(97) \quad (\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \phi, \epsilon) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^6$$

satisfying the size conditions

$$(98) \quad |\alpha| + |\beta| = |\gamma|, \quad |\beta| + |\delta| = |\phi|, \quad |\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = |\epsilon|.$$

We denote $|\epsilon| = k$. The following is a restatement of ?? from the introduction.

`thm:tet_iff_body`

Theorem 16. *Let $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^6$ be a 6-tuple satisfying the trace conditions. Then, Hermitian matrices satisfying Eq. (96) with eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) exist if and only if for all triples of positive weights $(\alpha, \beta, \delta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^3$, the following inequalities are satisfied*

`eq:tet_iff_body`

$$(99) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\} \right\|_\infty (\varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\delta(d) \varphi_\phi(f) \varphi_\gamma(c) \varphi_\epsilon(e))^{\frac{1}{3}}.$$

Furthermore, if inequalities ?? hold true for all triples $(\alpha, \beta, \delta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^3$ with $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = k$, then

`eq:tet_dist_bound_body`

$$(100) \quad \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]} D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) \leq O\left(n \sqrt{\frac{\log k}{k}}\right).$$

Proof. Our proof of ?? is divided into two parts. First we prove the necessity of Eq. (99) in Section 3.1. Then afterwards we prove the distance bound in Eq. (100). Providing proofs for these two claims yields the whole theorem because the satisfaction of Eq. (99) for all (α, β, δ) with $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = k$ implies Eq. (100) holds for all k , and thus the $k \rightarrow \infty$ limit implies $D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) = 0$ (because $\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \log(k+1)/k = 0$) which means (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral. $\square$

sec:tet_necess

3.1. Necessary conditions. First, we assume that there exists matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) with eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) satisfying Eq. (96). The result of Proposition 8 applied to $X \mapsto A, Y \mapsto B$, and $Z \mapsto D$ produces

$$(101) \quad \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) \right| \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} \varphi_{\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D)^{\frac{1}{2}} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D)^{\frac{1}{2}}.$$

Then four applications of Proposition 9 produces

$$(102) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_{\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) &\leq (\varphi_{\alpha}(A)\varphi_{\phi}(F))^{\frac{2}{3}} \varphi_{\epsilon}(E)^{\frac{1}{3}}, \\ \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) &\leq (\varphi_{\gamma}(C)\varphi_{\delta}(D))^{\frac{2}{3}} \varphi_{\epsilon}(E)^{\frac{1}{3}}. \end{aligned}$$

These bounds combined yields:

$$(103) \quad \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) \right| \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} (\varphi_{\alpha}(A)\varphi_{\delta}(D)\varphi_{\phi}(F)\varphi_{\gamma}(C)\varphi_{\epsilon}(E))^{\frac{1}{3}}.$$

We then compute,

$$(104) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b)\varphi_{\delta}(d) &= \varphi_{\alpha}(A)\varphi_{\beta}(B)\varphi_{\delta}(D), \\ &= \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D), \\ &\leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) \right|, \\ &\leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} (\varphi_{\alpha}(A)\varphi_{\delta}(D)\varphi_{\phi}(F)\varphi_{\gamma}(C)\varphi_{\epsilon}(E))^{\frac{1}{3}}, \\ &= \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} (\varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\delta}(d)\varphi_{\phi}(f)\varphi_{\gamma}(c)\varphi_{\epsilon}(e))^{\frac{1}{3}}, \end{aligned}$$

as desired.

3.2. Distance bound & sufficiency. Let $(a, b, c, d, e, f) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^6$ which satisfy the trace conditions and also

$$(105) \quad \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b)\varphi_{\delta}(d) \leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} (\varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\phi}(f)\varphi_{\gamma}(c)\varphi_{\delta}(d)\varphi_{\epsilon}(e))^{\frac{1}{3}}$$

for all $(\alpha, \beta, \delta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^3$. We will consider triples with $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\gamma| = k$ for some fixed integer k . Denote by $(\gamma^*, \epsilon^*, \phi^*)$ the triple for which the corresponding term on the right hand side is maximal. We have,

$$(106) \quad \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b)\varphi_{\delta}(d) \leq (k+1)^{3n} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} (\varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\phi^*}(f)\varphi_{\gamma^*}(c)\varphi_{\delta}(d)\varphi_{\epsilon^*}(e))^{\frac{1}{3}},$$

where $(k+1)^{3n}$ serves as an upper bound on the number of terms in the sum in Eq. (105). Equation (179) then implies strict positivity

$$(107) \quad \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b)\varphi_{\delta}(d) > 0 \implies \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty} > 0,$$

which will enable us to divide by $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|$ momentarily.

At the same time, by Lemma 15, we have

$$(108) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \left| \varphi_{\gamma^* \epsilon^* \phi^*}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A^*, B^*, D^*) \right|$$

where $(A^*, B^*, D^*) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b \times \mathcal{O}_d$ is a triple of matrices which realizes a maximum of $\left| \varphi_{\gamma^* \epsilon^* \phi^*}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) \right|$. Then, applying Eq. (103) here yields

{eq:second_abd_bound}

$$(109) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma^* \\ \delta & \epsilon^* & \phi^* \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty (\varphi_\alpha(A^*) \varphi_{\phi^*}(F^*) \varphi_{\gamma^*}(C^*) \varphi_\delta(D^*) \varphi_{\epsilon^*}(E^*))^{\frac{1}{3}}.$$

where $C^* := A^* + B^*$, $E^* := A^* + B^* + D^*$, $F^* := B^* + D^*$.

Now we (i) multiply the estimate in Eq. (106) by the estimate in Eq. (109), (ii) divide by $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2$ and use the operator norm estimate from Eq. (29) to obtain $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty^2$, and (iii) take a square root to obtain:

{eq:varphi_sixth_root}

$$(110) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq (k+1)^{\frac{3}{2}\binom{n}{2} + \frac{3}{2}n} (\varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_{\phi^*}(f) \varphi_{\gamma^*}(c) \varphi_\delta(d) \varphi_{\epsilon^*}(e))^{\frac{1}{6}} \times (\varphi_\alpha(A^*) \varphi_{\phi^*}(F^*) \varphi_{\gamma^*}(C^*) \varphi_\delta(D^*) \varphi_{\epsilon^*}(E^*))^{\frac{1}{6}}.$$

From here, we can apply the eigenvalue separation lemma (Lemma 13), or rather, the estimate from Eq. (84) to relax the above estimate even further. For instance, we have by Eq. (84) and $|\phi| \leq k$ the estimate

$$(111) \quad \begin{aligned} (\varphi_{\phi^*}(f) \varphi_{\phi^*}(F^*))^{\frac{1}{2}} &\leq (|\phi|+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \frac{1}{|\phi|!} \text{BC}(f, \text{eig}(F^*))^{|\phi|}, \\ &\leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \frac{1}{|\phi|!} \text{BC}(f, \text{eig}(F^*))^{|\phi|}. \end{aligned}$$

Also, as $\text{eig}(A^*) = a$, we have $\varphi_\alpha(A^*) = \varphi_\alpha(a)$, and thus by Eq. (37)

$$(112) \quad (\varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\alpha(A^*))^{\frac{1}{2}} = \varphi_\alpha(a) \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[a]^{|\alpha|}}{|\alpha|!}.$$

Putting these two estimates above together, we arrive at

$$\begin{aligned}
 & (\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\alpha(A^*)\varphi_{\phi^*}(f)\varphi_{\phi^*}(F^*))^{\frac{1}{2}} \\
 & \leq \frac{1}{|\alpha|!|\phi|!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \text{Tr}[a]^{|\alpha|} \text{BC}(f, \text{eig}(F^*))^{|\phi|}, \\
 (113) \quad & \leq \frac{1}{k!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} (\text{Tr}[a] + \text{BC}(f, \text{eig}(F^*)))^k, \\
 & = \frac{1}{k!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \text{BC}(a \oplus f, a \oplus \text{eig}(F^*))^k, \\
 & \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{8 \text{Tr}[e]^2} \|f - \text{eig}(F^*)\|_1^2\right).
 \end{aligned}$$

Similarly, we obtain

$$(114) \quad (\varphi_\alpha(d)\varphi_\alpha(D^*)\varphi_{\gamma^*}(c)\varphi_{\gamma^*}(C^*))^{\frac{1}{2}} \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{8 \text{Tr}[e]^2} \|c - \text{eig}(C^*)\|_1^2\right),$$

and

$$(115) \quad (\varphi_\epsilon(e)\varphi_\epsilon(E^*))^{\frac{1}{2}} \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{8 \text{Tr}[e]^2} \|e - \text{eig}(E^*)\|_1^2\right).$$

Applying these distance relaxations to the the inequality in Eq. (110), this implies

$$(116) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)\varphi_\delta(d) \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} (k+1)^{\frac{3}{2}\binom{n}{2} + \frac{3}{2}n + \binom{n}{2}} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{24 \text{Tr}[e]^2} D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right)\right).$$

Here we have used the fact that

$$(117) \quad \|f - \text{eig}(F^*)\|_1^2 + \|e - \text{eig}(E^*)\|_1^2 + \|c - \text{eig}(C^*)\|_1^2 \geq D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right).$$

Summing over the triples (α, β, δ) with $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = k$ yields

$$(118) \quad 1 \leq (k+1)^{\frac{3}{2}\binom{n}{2} + \frac{3}{2}n + \binom{n}{2} + 3n} \exp\left(-\frac{k}{24 \text{Tr}[e]^2} D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right)\right),$$

where we have estimated by $(k+1)^{3n}$ the number of summands. Altogether, this implies

$$\text{\textcolor{blue}{(eq:final_estimate)}} \quad (119) \quad \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]^2} D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) \leq n(30n + 78) \frac{\log(k+1)}{k},$$

as required.

4. ASYMPTOTICS OF $U(n)$ 6j SYMBOLS

In this section we provide a proof of Theorem 2, specifically, Section 4.1 provides the proof of the inverse polynomial lower bound while Section 4.2 provides the proof of the exponential upper bound. Before proceeding, we prove the following lemma which will be used in both portions of the proof.

lem:asym_sixj_helper

Lemma 17. *Let $X, Y, Z \in \mathcal{H}_n^+$ and let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be the eigenvalues of the matrices $(X, Y, X+Y, Z, X+Y+Z, Y+Z)$. Then for all $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^{\times 6}$ satisfying the size conditions of Eq. (51) with $|\epsilon_k| = k$, we have*

{eq:hex_rel_ent_bound}

$$(120) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \right| \leq (k+1)^{n(n-1)} \exp \left(-k R_{abcdef}^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} \right),$$

where

$$(121) \quad R_{abcdef}^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} = \frac{1}{4} \left[D \left(\frac{\alpha \oplus \beta \oplus \delta}{k} \left\| \frac{a \oplus b \oplus d}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) + D \left(\frac{\gamma \oplus \delta}{k} \left\| \frac{c \oplus d}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) + \dots + D \left(\frac{\alpha \oplus \phi}{k} \left\| \frac{a \oplus f}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) + D \left(\frac{\epsilon}{k} \left\| \frac{e}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) \right].$$

Note that $R_{abcdef}^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} \geq 0$ with equality holding only if

$$(122) \quad \frac{1}{k}(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k) = \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]}(a, b, c, d, e, f).$$

Proof. Using Proposition 8, Proposition 9 and $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty \leq 1$, we obtain

{eq:abs_quad_bound}

$$(123) \quad \left| \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(X, Y, Z) \right| \leq (\varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \times \varphi_\gamma(c) \varphi_\delta(d) \times \varphi_\epsilon(e) \times \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\phi(f))^{\frac{1}{4}}.$$

Using the multinomial distribution bound from Proposition 10, we observe

$$(124) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) &\leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \frac{a_1^{\alpha_1}}{\alpha_1!} \dots \frac{a_n^{\alpha_n}}{\alpha_n!} \frac{b_1^{\beta_1}}{\beta_1!} \dots \frac{b_n^{\beta_n}}{\beta_n!} \frac{d_1^{\delta_1}}{\delta_1!} \dots \frac{d_n^{\delta_n}}{\delta_n!}, \\ &= (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} m_{\alpha \oplus \beta \oplus \delta}(a \oplus b \oplus d). \end{aligned}$$

Then applying the relative entropy bound from the proof of Proposition 12 yields

$$(125) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \exp \left[-k D \left(\frac{\alpha \oplus \beta \oplus \delta}{k} \left\| \frac{a \oplus b \oplus d}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) \right].$$

Analogously, we obtain

$$(126) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \varphi_\gamma(c) \varphi_\delta(d) \leq (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}} \exp \left[-k D \left(\frac{\gamma \oplus \delta}{k} \left\| \frac{c \oplus d}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) \right],$$

$$(127) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\phi(f) \leq (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}} \exp \left[-k D \left(\frac{\alpha \oplus \phi}{k} \left\| \frac{a \oplus f}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) \right],$$

$$(128) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \varphi_\epsilon(e) \leq (k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \exp \left[-k D \left(\frac{\epsilon}{k} \left\| \frac{e}{\text{Tr}[e]} \right\| \right) \right].$$

Applying these bounds to Eq. (123) we obtain Eq. (120). $\square$

sec:6j_inverse_poly

4.1. Inverse polynomial lower bound. Assume (a, b, c, d, e, f) are the eigenvalues of positive semidefinite matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfying the tetrahedral constraints. Summing $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D)$ over all sextuples of Young diagrams satisfying the size conditions Eq. (51) produces

$$(129) \quad \sum_{\substack{\alpha, \beta, \delta \\ \gamma, \epsilon, \phi \\ |\epsilon|=k}} \varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D) = \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!}.$$

Let $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ denote the sextuple which maximizes the absolute value of $\varphi_{\gamma\epsilon\phi}^{\alpha\beta\delta}(A, B, D)$ in the above sum. As there are at most $(k+1)^{6\text{rank}[e]}$ terms in the above summation which are non-zero, we conclude

{eq:inverse_poly_varphi_lower}

$$(130) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e]^k} \left| \varphi_{\gamma_k \epsilon_k \phi_k}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \delta_k}(A, B, D) \right| \geq \frac{1}{(k+1)^{6\text{rank}[e]}}$$

Then by Proposition 8, Proposition 9 and Eq. (37), we conclude

{eq:inverse_poly_varphi_upper}

$$(131) \quad \left| \varphi_{\gamma_k \epsilon_k \phi_k}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \delta_k}(A, B, D) \right| \leq \frac{\text{Tr}[e]^k}{k!} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty}.$$

Combining Eq. (130) and Eq. (131) then gives Eq. (15). To prove the convergence portion of the claim, we combine Lemma 17 with Eq. (130) to obtain

$$(132) \quad \exp \left(-k R_{abcdef}^{\alpha\beta\gamma\delta\epsilon\phi} \right) \leq \frac{1}{(k+1)^{6\text{rank}[e]+n(n-1)}},$$

which implies $\lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} R_{abcdef}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \gamma_k \delta_k \epsilon_k \phi_k} = 0$ which implies the convergence claim of Theorem 2.

sec:6j_exp

4.2. Exponential upper bound. We now prove the exponential decay on $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_{\infty}$ when $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ converges to some non-tetrahedral eigenvalues. Without loss of generality, we can assume the Young diagrams $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ satisfy the size constraints Eq. (51) as before (since otherwise $\left\{ \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\} = 0$). To begin, Lemma 15 gives

$$(133) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \varphi_{\alpha_k}(a) \varphi_{\beta_k}(b) \varphi_{\delta_k}(d) \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}} \max_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b \times \mathcal{O}_d}} \left| \varphi_{\gamma_k \epsilon_k \phi_k}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \delta_k}(X, Y, Z) \right|.$$

Now we freely choose, for each k , a particular triple of eigenvalues (a^*, b^*, d^*) which ensures

$$(134) \quad \frac{k!}{\text{Tr}[e^*]^k} \varphi_{\alpha_k}(a^*) \varphi_{\beta_k}(b^*) \varphi_{\delta_k}(d^*) \geq \frac{1}{(k+1)^{3n}}.$$

where we are denoting the sum $\text{Tr}[a^*] + \text{Tr}[b^*] + \text{Tr}[d^*]$ with $\text{Tr}[e^*]$ by a slight abuse of notation as no eigenvalues e^* have been chosen here. That such a

choice can always be made follows from the normalization condition

$$(135) \quad \sum_{\substack{\alpha, \beta, \delta \\ |\alpha|+|\beta|+|\delta|=k}} \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d) = \frac{(\text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d])^k}{k!},$$

and noting that there are at most $(k+1)^{3n}$ such triples (α, β, δ) of Young diagrams in the sum (indeed it suffices to choose (a^*, b^*, d^*) to maximize $\varphi_{\alpha_k}(a) \varphi_{\beta_k}(b) \varphi_{\delta_k}(d)$). Therefore, we obtain the upper bound

$$(136) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}+3n} \frac{\text{Tr}[e^*]^k}{k!} \max_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_{a^*} \times \mathcal{O}_{b^*} \times \mathcal{O}_{d^*}}} \left| \varphi_{\gamma_k \epsilon_k \phi_k}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \delta_k}(X, Y, Z) \right|.$$

Then applying Lemma 17 produces

$$(137) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}+3n+n(n-1)} \exp \left(-k \min_{\substack{(X,Y,Z) \in \\ \mathcal{O}_{a^*} \times \mathcal{O}_{b^*} \times \mathcal{O}_{d^*}}} R_{a^* b^* c^* d^* e^* f^*}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \gamma_k \delta_k \epsilon_k \phi_k} \right).$$

where $c^* = \exp(X+Y)$, $f^* = \exp(Y+Z)$, and $e^* = \exp(X+Y+Z)$.

Finally, since it was assumed that $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ are converging to non-tetrahedral eigenvalues, there must exist a sufficiently large K such that for all $k \geq K$ and all tetrahedral eigenvalues (a', b', c', d', e', f') , we have a separation $R_{a' b' c' d' e' f'}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \gamma_k \delta_k \epsilon_k \phi_k} \geq r$ for some positive constant $r > 0$. Since $(a^*, b^*, c^*, d^*, e^*, f^*)$ are tetrahedral eigenvalues, we can conclude for such sufficiently large $k \geq K$, $R_{a^* b^* c^* d^* e^* f^*}^{\alpha_k \beta_k \gamma_k \delta_k \epsilon_k \phi_k} \geq r$ and therefore

$$(138) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq (k+1)^{3\binom{n}{2}+3n+n(n-1)} \exp(-kr),$$

which proves the desired exponential decay on the operator norm because of the standard norm estimate $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2$.

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5. [TC] INTRODUCTION

Horn’s problem: The problem of determining the set of eigenvalues (a, b, c) of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) satisfying $A + B = C$ has been investigated for over a century [Wey12; Fan49; Lid53; Wie55; TF71; TF70] and has come to be known as *Horn’s problem* after Horn who, in 1962, conjectured a solution to the problem in the form of an inductively defined, finite set of homogeneous linear inequalities. In 1998, Klyachko provided a solution to Horn’s problem [Kly98] which, when combined with a proof of the so-called saturation conjecture, due to Knutson and Tao [KT99], constitutes a proof of Horn’s original conjecture [Ful98]. These linear inequalities, now known as the *Horn inequalities* describe the convex polytope of admissible values for (a, b, c) . Recent developments on Horn’s problem include the development of the geometric method by Sherman [She15] and Berline, Vergne, and Walter [BVW18] originally pioneered by the geometric proofs due to Belkale [Bel02; Bel05], as well the characterization and computation of the induced distribution over the eigenvalues c of the sum $C = A + B$ if A and B are sampled uniformly and independently from the respective sets of Hermitian matrices with eigenvalues a and b by Coquereaux, McSwiggen, and Zuber in series of papers [CZ18; CZ18; CMZ19; Zub18]. For a pedagogical and historical introduction to Horn’s problem, we recommend the review articles of Bhatia [Bha01], Knutson [Knu00], and Fulton [Ful00] or alternatively [NP06, Appendix D]. See also the article by Daftuar and Hayden for an account of applications to topics in quantum information theory [DH05].

In parallel to Horn’s problem, variations and extensions of Horn’s problem have been explored by numerous authors. For example, Agnihotri and Woodward, Belkale, and [BK16] have studied the eigenvalues of unitary matrices and their product [AW97; Bel08; BK16], or the admissible singular values of matrices and their product [Spe05; TT71]. In 2000, it was shown by [Kly00] that *logarithms* of the admissible singular values of non-singular matrices and their product are identical to the admissible eigenvalues of Hermitian matrices and their sum, thus proving a conjecture due to Thompson [Kly00; AMW01].

The tetrahedral Horn problem: In this paper, we consider a generalization of Horn’s problem investigated previously only briefly in [CSW18]. While Horn’s problem aims to characterize the eigenvalues (a, b, c) of a triple of $n \times n$ Hermitian matrices (A, B, C) which are subjected to the constraint $A + B = C$, the generalization we consider here aims to characterize the possible eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) of a *sextuple* of $n \times n$ matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) subject to four constraints:

{eq:tet_cond}

$$(139) \quad A + B = C, \quad B + D = F, \quad D + C = E, \quad \text{and} \quad A + F = E.$$

These constraints arise naturally from building a tetrahedral arrangement of $n \times n$ Hermitian matrices inside the vector space of such Hermitian matrices

with edges labelled according to Fig. 2. For this reason, we refer to this eigenvalue problem as the *tetrahedral* Horn problem and we say a sextuple of eigenvalues, (a, b, c, d, e, f) , is *tetrahedral* if such matrices exist, and not tetrahedral otherwise. It is possible to view the tetrahedral Horn problem

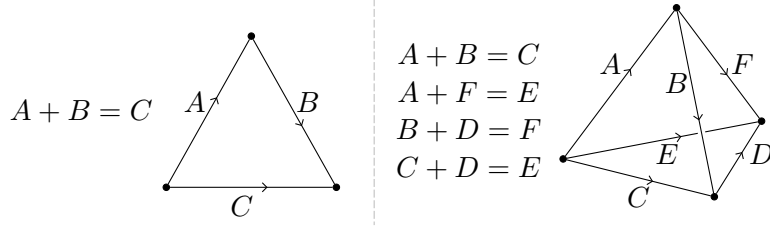


FIGURE 2. (Left) Horn's problem subjects three Hermitian matrices, (A, B, C) , to the constraint $A + B = C$ forming a triangle in the vector space of Hermitian matrices. (Right) The *tetrahedral* Horn problem subjects six Hermitian matrices, (A, B, C, D, E, F) , to a quadruple of constraints forming a tetrahedron in the vector space of Hermitian matrices. fig:tetrahedron_labelling_scheme

as the conjunction of four separate instances of the original Horn original problem subject to *additional* matching constraints. Specifically, a sextuple of eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) is tetrahedral only if each of the following four triplets are trigonal:

{eq:four_faces}

$$(140) \quad (a, b, c), \quad (b, d, f), \quad (c, d, e), \quad (a, f, e).$$

If each of the above triplets are separately compatible in the sense of the original Horn problem, then there exists a set of twelve Hermitian matrices with the corresponding eigenvalues satisfying

{eq:four_faces_matrices}

$$(141) \quad A + B = C, \quad B' + D = F, \quad C' + D' = E, \quad A' + F' = E'.$$

The tetrahedral Horn problem goes beyond four separate instances of Horn's original problem in that it additionally requires the corresponding pairs of primed and unprimed Hermitian matrices above must coincide.

The case of 2×2 matrices: Beyond the superficial connection between the imposed constraints and the resulting shape formed in the vector space of Hermitian matrices (as in Fig. 2), in the special case of 2×2 Hermitian matrices, this connection is much deeper. Without loss of generality, it is always possible to restrict attention to the case of *traceless* Hermitian matrices (see Appendix A). Moreover, every 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrix can be identified by a three-dimensional vector $v = (v_1, v_2, v_3) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ using the formula:

$$(142) \quad X = \begin{pmatrix} v_3 & v_1 - iv_2 \\ v_1 + iv_2 & -v_3 \end{pmatrix},$$

in which case, the eigenvalues of X are given by

$$(143) \quad \text{eig}(X) = (\ell_x, -\ell_x),$$

where $\ell_x = \|v\|_2 = \sqrt{v_1^2 + v_2^2 + v_3^2}$ is the Euclident length of the vector v . As a consequence, the eigenvalues for a triangular arrangement of 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrices is isomorphic to the moduli space of sidelengths of Euclidean *triangles* in $\mathbb{R}^3$ [HK96; FKL10; Knu00]. This correspondence generalizes to the tetrahedral case in the sense that the space of admissible eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) for a tetrahedral arrangements of 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrices is equivalent to the moduli space of Euclidean *tetrahedra* in $\mathbb{R}^3$. This geometric knowledge about the solution space then leads to a complete solution to the tetrahedral Horn's problem for 2×2 matrices [Ric02; WD09]; specifically, the moduli space of Euclidean tetrahedra in $\mathbb{R}^3$ is described by the conjunction of the triangle inequalities for each of the ~~four~~ ^{four} faces,

$$(144) \quad |\ell_a - \ell_b| \leq \ell_c \leq \ell_a + \ell_b, \quad |\ell_b - \ell_d| \leq \ell_f \leq \ell_b + \ell_d, \quad |\ell_d - \ell_c| \leq \ell_e \leq \ell_d + \ell_c, \quad |\ell_a - \ell_f| \leq \ell_e \leq \ell_a + \ell_f,$$

together with a non-linear inequality [SJS18]:

$$(145) \quad \text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f) = \frac{1}{288} \det \begin{pmatrix} 0 & \ell_a^2 & \ell_c^2 & \ell_e^2 & 1 \\ \ell_a^2 & 0 & \ell_b^2 & \ell_f^2 & 1 \\ \ell_c^2 & \ell_b^2 & 0 & \ell_d^2 & 1 \\ \ell_e^2 & \ell_f^2 & \ell_d^2 & 0 & 1 \\ 1 & 1 & 1 & 1 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \geq 0.$$

The quantity $\text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f)$ is known as a Cayley-Menger determinant; if $\text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f)$ is positive and if the triangle inequalities above are satisfied, the value of $\text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f)$ is equal to *square* of the volume of the corresponding tetrahedron [SJS18, Equation 5.2]². Figure 3 depicts a three-dimensional projection of the solution space described by Eq. (144) and Eq. (145). Before proceeding, we remark that even for the case of 2×2 matrices, there is a strong qualitative difference between the tetrahedral Horn problem and the original Horn problem. In particular, while the solution to the original Horn problem is completely characterized by a convex polytope (i.e., by a finite number of linear inequalities in the eigenvalues), the solution space for the tetrahedral Horn's problem is neither convex nor a polytope.

Our contributions: Regarding the tetrahedral Horn problem, we derive a new family of inequalities constraining the set of tetrahedral eigenvalues.

²The triangle inequalities $|\ell_a - \ell_b| \leq \ell_c \leq \ell_a + \ell_b$ are also equivalent to the non-negativity of the *area*, $\text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c)$, of the triangle with side-lengths ℓ_a, ℓ_b and ℓ_c where

$$\text{CM}(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c)^2 = -\frac{1}{16} \det \begin{pmatrix} 0 & 1 & 1 & 1 \\ 1 & 0 & \ell_a^2 & \ell_c^2 \\ 1 & \ell_a^2 & 0 & \ell_b^2 \\ 1 & \ell_c^2 & \ell_b^2 & 0 \end{pmatrix} \text{ is equivalent to Heron's formula.}$$

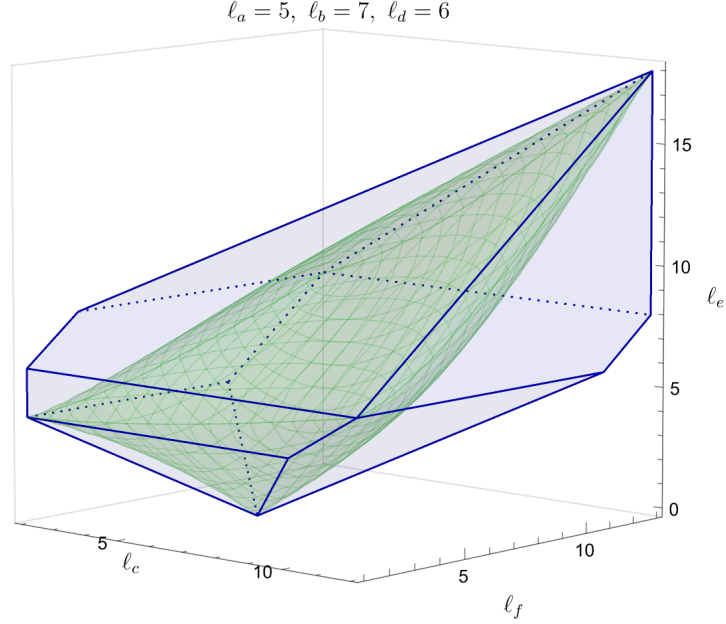


FIGURE 3. A comparison between the values for (ℓ_c, ℓ_e, ℓ_f) with fixed $(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_d) = (5, 7, 6)$ which merely satisfy the triangle inequalities (exterior blue polytope) and those which additionally satisfy the Cayley-Menger determinant inequality (interior green). The interior green region depicts (a slice of) the space of Euclidean tetrahedra with side lengths $(\ell_a, \ell_b, \ell_c, \ell_d, \ell_e, \ell_f)$ and thus depicts the solution to the tetrahedral Horn problem for 2×2 traceless Hermitian matrices; remark that it is neither a polytope nor convex. fig: tetrahedron_moduli_space_example

These inequalities are expressed in terms of Schur polynomials $s_\lambda(x)$ of the involved eigenvalues which are homogeneous symmetric polynomials indexed by Young diagrams λ . More accurately, we find our inequalities are best articulated in terms of a simple rescaling of the Schur polynomials, $\varphi_\lambda(x) := s_\lambda(x)/H_\lambda$, where H_λ is a positive integer equal to the product of the hook-lengths of all boxes in the Young diagram λ . These inequalities are presented in the following theorem. thm: tet_iff

Theorem 18. *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be a sextuple of non-negative eigenvalues of length n satisfying the trace conditions:* {eq: tet_trace_conditions}

(146)

$\text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b] = \text{Tr}[c], \text{Tr}[b] + \text{Tr}[d] = \text{Tr}[f], \text{Tr}[c] + \text{Tr}[d] = \text{Tr}[e], \text{and } \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[f] = \text{Tr}[e].$

Then there exists Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) with satisfying $A + B = C, B + D = F, C + D = E$ and $A + F = E$ with eigenvalues

(a, b, c, d, e, f) if and only if for all triples of Young diagrams (α, β, δ) ,

$$(147) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a)^{\frac{2}{3}} \varphi_\beta(b) \varphi_\delta(d)^{\frac{2}{3}} \leq \sum_{\gamma, \epsilon, \phi} \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_\infty \varphi_\phi(f)^{\frac{1}{3}} \varphi_\gamma(c)^{\frac{1}{3}} \varphi_\epsilon(e)^{\frac{1}{3}}.$$

The expression $\begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix}$ appearing above is an operator known as the $6j$ -symbol for the group of unitary $n \times n$ matrices $U(n)$ whose significance will be explained shortly. While Theorem 18 provides a complete characterization of the set of tetrahedral eigenvalues, it does so using an infinite number of inequalities. Nevertheless, we prove the finite subset of such inequalities of fixed degree $k = |\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta|$ is sufficient to characterize the set of sextuples of eigenvalues, (a, b, c, d, e, f) , which are *approximately* tetrahedral in the sense that their distance, $D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right)$, to the set of tetrahedral eigenvalues is small.

thm:approx_tet

Theorem 19. *If (a, b, c, d, e, f) are non-negative eigenvalues satisfying the trace conditions in Eq. (146) and also ?? for all triples (α, β, δ) such that $|\alpha| + |\beta| + |\delta| = k$ for some positive integer k , then*

eq:tri_abd_cef_dist_bound

$$(148) \quad \frac{1}{\text{Tr}[e]} D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) \leq O\left(n \sqrt{\frac{\log k}{k}}\right),$$

eq:defn_tet_deviation where $D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right)$ is the distance measure

$$(149) \quad D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) := \min_{\substack{(A, B, D) \sim \\ \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b \times \mathcal{O}_d}} \|\text{eig}(A+B) - c\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(B+D) - f\|_1^2 + \|\text{eig}(A+B+D) - e\|_1^2.$$

Note that $D\left(\begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix}\right) = 0$ if and only if (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral.

Note this theorem actually implies the “if” portion of ?? as one can take $k \rightarrow \infty$. Along the way, we derive an analogous set of inequalities for the original Horn problem along with an accompanying distance bound.

6j-symbols: Given a complex reductive group G with unitary irreducible representations (irreps) V_λ labelled by highest weights λ along with tensor-product multiplicity spaces, $M_{\alpha, \beta}^\gamma := \text{Hom}_G(V_\gamma, V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta)$, the $6j$ -symbols are maps between these multiplicity spaces which encode the associativity constraint $(V_\alpha \otimes V_\beta) \otimes V_\gamma \cong V_\alpha \otimes (V_\beta \otimes V_\gamma)$ between a triple of irreps, V_α, V_β , and V_δ of G . Specifically, a $6j$ -symbol depends on six irreps, $V_\alpha, V_\beta, V_\gamma, V_\delta, V_\epsilon$, and V_ϕ , and is the linear map between multiplicity spaces of the type

$$\begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} : M_{\alpha, \beta}^\gamma \otimes M_{\delta, \gamma}^\epsilon \rightarrow M_{\alpha, \phi}^\epsilon \otimes M_{\beta, \delta}^\phi,$$

corresponding to the block-wise components of the canonical isomorphism from $\bigotimes_\gamma M_{\alpha, \beta}^\gamma \otimes M_{\delta, \gamma}^\epsilon$ to $\bigotimes_\phi M_{\alpha, \beta}^\gamma \otimes M_{\delta, \gamma}^\epsilon$. Whenever the group G is multiplicity-free, in the sense that the dimensions of all multiplicity spaces, $m_{\alpha, \beta}^\gamma :=$

$\dim M_{\alpha,\beta}^\gamma$, are either zero or one, the corresponding $6j$ -symbol is merely a scalar quantity.

Wigner’s $6j$ -symbol for $SU(2)$: The group $SU(2)$ is multiplicity-free and the $6j$ -symbols for $SU(2)$ are, depending on the normalization and/or phase convention, are also referred to as Wigner $6j$ -symbols or Wigner $6j$ -coefficients [Wig93] or the Racah W -coefficients [Rac42]. The $6j$ -symbols for $SU(2)$ play a foundational role in the quantum theory of angular momentum, modelling the recoupling theory of three angular momenta, and thus they are used frequently in calculations involving the scattering of multiple particles in nuclear, atomic and molecular physics [VMK88; Edm96; Aqu+12]. Beyond the direct application to the theory of angular momenta, the $6j$ -symbols for $SU(2)$ also constitute a primitive object in the theory of spin networks [Pen71; BS10], representing a minimal non-trivial closed spin network. General spin networks are networks of trivalent vertices and connections labelled by irreps (spins) of $SU(2)$ which provide a discrete/combinatorial and manifestly invariant model with applications to gauge theories on graphs or manifolds [Bae96], invariants of knots and manifolds [Res87; TV92], topological quantum field theory [DJN93], elementary gates in spin network models for quantum computing [MR05], quantum change-point discrimination [AH11], and various aspects of proposed models for quantum gravity [Bae99; BC98; Bar03; Rov04; Mou84].

Throughout this paper, by the *asymptotics* of $6j$ -symbols, we are referring to their behaviour in the regime wherein the six highest weights, $\lambda \in \{\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi\}$, are becoming larger and larger in a suitable sense. The asymptotics of the $6j$ -symbol for $SU(2)$, wherein the irreps of dimension $\ell + 1$ may be identified either by integers $\ell \in \{0, 1, \dots\}$ or half-integers $j = \frac{\ell}{2} \in \{0, \frac{1}{2}, 1, \frac{3}{2}, \dots\}$, were initially investigated by Wigner [Wig60, Chapter 27]. In the context of the quantum theory of angular momenta, the limit of large ℓ , or equivalently large spins j , may also be interpreted as the limit wherein Planck’s constant tends to zero, $\hbar \propto \frac{1}{k} \rightarrow 0$, which suppresses the effects of quantizing angular momentum; therefore, these asymptotic limits are also known as *semiclassical* limits. Given three particles with spins $\frac{a}{2}$, $\frac{b}{2}$ and $\frac{d}{2}$ and total spin $\frac{e}{2}$, the $6j$ -symbol, $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$, can be interpreted as the quantum mechanical amplitude to observe the first and second particles to have combined spin $\frac{c}{2}$ given the second and third have combined spin $\frac{f}{2}$ [Wig60; Rob99]. Wigner considered the probability for this event to occur in the asymptotic limit of large spins, i.e., the square of the $6j$ -symbol, and conjectured the estimate:

$$\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{smallmatrix} \right\}^2 \approx \frac{1}{3\pi V}$$

where V is the volume of the Euclidean tetrahedron with side-lengths (a, b, c, d, e, f) . Building upon the work of Wigner, Ponzano and Regge conjectured a formula for the amplitude of the $6j$ -symbol itself in the limit of large spins

[PR68]. Later, using techniques from geometric quantization theory, Roberts rigorously proved an asymptotic formula which is equivalent to the conjecture of Ponzano and Regge (up to minor differences) [Rob99].

Theorem 20 (Roberts). *If (a, b, c, d, e, f) are integer side-lengths of a Euclidean tetrahedron with volume V and corresponding exterior dihedral angles³ $(\theta_a, \theta_b, \theta_c, \theta_d, \theta_e, \theta_f)$, then*

$$\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} ka & kb & kc \\ kd & ke & kf \end{smallmatrix} \right\} \stackrel{k \rightarrow \infty}{\sim} \sqrt{\frac{2}{3\pi V k^3}} \cos \left(\sum_{\ell} (k\ell + 1) \frac{\theta_{\ell}}{2} + \frac{\pi}{4} \right),$$

where the sum is over the six sides ℓ . Otherwise, if there does not exist a Euclidean tetrahedron with side-lengths (a, b, c, d, e, f) , then $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} ka & kb & kc \\ kd & ke & kf \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ decays to zero at an exponential rate as $k \rightarrow \infty$.

A proof of the Ponzano-Regge asymptotic formula was also obtained by Chen, Ismail, and Simeonov [CIS99] (with a correction by Watson [Wat99]) using estimates from the theory of hypergeometric functions. Additional proofs of this asymptotic correspondence between $6j$ -symbols for $SU(2)$ and Euclidean tetrahedra have emerged in recent years including the elementary proof by Gurau which applies Stirling's approximation directly to Racah's single-sum formula [Gur08] as well as group integral approach to evaluate so-called simple spin networks as Feynman graphs [FK00; FL03]. See also the paper by Bartlett and Nzaganya for an accessible presentation of these kinds of calculations [BN23]. Analogous asymptotic formulas have also been obtained by Taylor and Woodward for the $6j$ -symbol associated to the quantum group $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}_2)$ for a particular k -dependent parameter q [TW06]. In this generalized setting, the asymptotics calculated by Taylor and Woodward encode (i) the existence of a spherical tetrahedron on the unit sphere with prescribed edge-lengths whenever $q = \exp(i\pi/r(k))$ is an $r(k)$ th root of unity or (ii) the existence of a hyperbolic tetrahedron with prescribed edge-lengths when $q = \exp(\pi/r(k))$ is positive real (here $r(k) = k(r-2) + 2$ for $r > 2$ a fixed integer) [TW06].

More generally, that the asymptotics of representation-theoretic quantities (such as $6j$ -symbols) are controlled by the existence of some critical geometric object is explained by the theory of geometric quantization [Rob02]. Geometric quantization, broadly speaking, associates classical phase spaces modelled by symplectic manifolds to quantum phase spaces modelled by Hilbert spaces [Rob02; GS82; Kir04]. In particular, Kirillov's orbit principle [Kir04] proposes an association between (i) the coadjoint orbits of a compact Lie group G passing through an integral weight λ to (ii) the corresponding unitary irreps of G of highest weight λ . Furthermore, products of coadjoint orbits correspond to tensor products of irreps and moreover symplectic quotients of the resulting products of orbits are identified with

³For example, the exterior dihedral angle θ_a is the outside angle between the two faces of the tetrahedron sharing the common edge with side-length a .

invariant vectors in the resulting tensor products of irreps [Rob02; GS82]. For the aforementioned case of $SU(2)$, the coadjoint orbits can be identified the $SO(3)$ rotations of vectors in Euclidean $\mathbb{R}^3$ (i.e., spheres of fixed radius), and thus the asymptotics of representation-theoretic quantities for $SU(2)$ are controlled by the existence of corresponding geometric objects in Euclidean $\mathbb{R}^3$ with prescribed edge-lengths [Rob02].

6j-symbols for $U(n)$: One application of the techniques developed in this paper is to provide estimates for the asymptotics of the 6j symbols for the group $U(n)$ (or equivalently for $SU(n)$) wherein the polynomial irreps V_λ^n are labelled by highest-weights which can also be identified with Young diagrams λ . One of the primary difficulties in proving statements about 6j symbols for $U(n)$ for $n \geq 3$ is the presence of non-trivial multiplicity spaces, meaning the dimensions of tensor-product multiplicity spaces for $U(n)$, also known as Littlewood-Richardson coefficients, can be greater than one. Because of these difficulties, over the years, considerable attention has been placed on the study of $U(n)$ (or $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}_n)$) 6j symbols which are multiplicity-free in the sense that the dimensions of each of the multiplicity spaces is at most one [NPZ13; AMS20; Alc+23]. Indeed, as stated by Coquereaux, “apart from very few special cases (low dimension of irreps and no multiplicity), ... we are not aware of any published general result.” [Coq23].

Our approach bypasses the difficulties presented by multiplicities by focusing only on the *norms* of the 6j symbol for $U(n)$. Following the procedure provided by geometric quantization, one expects the asymptotics of the 6j-symbol for $U(n)$ to be controlled by existence of some kind of tetrahedral object in space of coadjoint orbits for $U(n)$. In particular, the coadjoint orbits of $U(n)$ can be identified with the orbits of $n \times n$ Hermitian matrices, X , under the conjugation action, $X \mapsto U^{-1}XU$, by unitary $n \times n$ matrices $U \in U(n)$; in other words, coadjoint orbits are associated to sets of $n \times n$ Hermitian matrices sharing a common set of eigenvalues $x = (x_1 \geq \dots \geq x_n)$. Using our methods we are able to prove the following inverse polynomial lower bound.

cor: asym_6j

Corollary 21. *If (a, b, c, d, e, f) are the eigenvalues of $n \times n$ of positive semidefinite matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfying $A + B = C$, $B + D = F$, $C + D = E$, and $A + F = E$, then there exists a sequence of Young diagrams $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ (with $|\epsilon_k| = k$) converging in proportion to the eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) such that*

$$(150) \quad \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\| \geq \frac{1}{\text{poly}(k)}.$$

Otherwise, if (a, b, c, d, e, f) are not the eigenvalues of any such matrices, then for any sequence of Young diagrams converging in proportion to (a, b, c, d, e, f) , we have exponential decay in the value of $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|$.

Before continuing, it is worth emphasizing the similarities and differences between our result and the asymptotic formula proven by Roberts above [Rob99]. First and foremost, our result goes beyond that of Roberts in the sense that it applies to the higher-rank Lie group $U(n)$ for $n \geq 3$. Moreover, our result, even when restricted to the case for $SU(2)$, goes beyond the statement proven by Roberts in the sense our result is applicable to *irrational* eigenvalues/edge-lengths, whereas the former is only applicable to *integer*, or with a minor re-scaling, *rational* eigenvalues/edge-lengths. Like the Ponzano-Regge formula, our result is different in that it merely promises the *existence* of a sextuple of sequences of Young diagrams, $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$, converging to the eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) , whereas the result of Roberts provides a concrete statement about the particular sequence of *scaled* Young diagrams $(k\alpha, k\beta, k\gamma, k\delta, k\epsilon, k\phi)$. Moreover, our result provides a polynomial lower bound on the value of the $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|$ and does not provide an asymptotic formula which would serve as the proper generalization of the Ponzano and Regge formula above [PR68]. The Ponzano and Regge formula for $SU(2)$ was traditionally obtained using the method of *stationary phases* which relies on both an integral formula for the $6j$ -symbol with exponential integrand along with a geometric understanding of the *isolated* critical points for the exponential phase [PR68; Gur08]. In the case of $SU(2)$ with generic edge-lengths, there is a formulation involving exactly *two* isolated critical points corresponding to (i) the $SO(3)$ -orbit $[\tau]$ of a Euclidean tetrahedron τ with given edge-lengths and (ii) the $SO(3)$ -orbit $[\tau']$ of the Euclidean tetrahedron τ' which is the mirror-image of the tetrahedron τ with the same fixed side lengths. Generalizing this type of criticality analysis to $U(n)$ for $n \geq 3$ appears to be a significant challenge, and even if an analysis was performed, one would still need to compute a corresponding Hessian for each critical point and evaluate the total contribution [Rob02]. Perhaps a different approach for deriving the Ponzano-Regge formula, such as those based on recursion relations or estimates of hypergeometric functions appearing in [CIS99; TW06; Art23; Art24] would be better suited for the case where $n \geq 3$.

Eigenvalue estimation: Our approach to proving the above theorems relies on the technique of *eigenvalue estimation*, a probabilistic technique developed in the context of quantum information theory for estimating the eigenvalues of positive semidefinite matrices which model the state of quantum systems [KW01; CM06; OW16; HM02; CHW07; Hay17]. The eigenvalue estimation technique relies heavily on the concept of Schur-Weyl duality which describes the decomposition of the k -th tensor power of the n -dimensional complex vector space $\mathbb{C}^n$, which supports representations of both the symmetric group S_k by permutation of tensor factors and the group of unitary matrices $U(n)$ (or more generally invertible complex matrices $GL(n, \mathbb{C})$), into irreducible invariant subspaces indexed by Young diagrams

$\lambda = (\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_n)$ with k boxes and at most n rows. Given a positive semi-definite matrix X with eigenvalues $x = (x_1, \dots, x_n)$, one can analogously decompose the k -th tensor power of X into the same irreducible invariant subspaces indexed by λ and then investigate the aptly named Schur-Weyl distribution, $p_x(\lambda) := \text{Tr}[\Pi_\lambda X^{\otimes k}] / \text{Tr}[X^{\otimes k}]$, which measures the relative proportion of the decomposed pieces of $X^{\otimes k}$ and depends only on the eigenvalues x of X . The technique of eigenvalue estimation relies on the fact that the Schur-Weyl distribution concentrates strongly around those Young diagrams λ which are proportional to eigenvalues x and that this concentration strengthens as the sizes of the Young diagrams grow to infinity [KW01; CM06; OW16]. Applying the eigenvalue estimation technique to the original Horn problem was first done by Christandl [Chr08]. In this paper, we develop a technique called *eigenvalue separation* which relates the similarity between two Schur-Weyl distributions, $p_x(\lambda)$ and $p_y(\lambda)$, to the similarity of the underlying eigenvalues, x and y , and apply this technique to tetrahedral Horn problem and obtain ???. In addition, our approach produces new results for the original Horn problem, analogous to ???, beyond those obtained in [Chr08].

Quantum marginals & the $6j$ -symbol for the symmetric group

S_k : Our method for proving Corollary 21 is closely related to techniques used in an earlier paper by Christandl, Şahinoğlu, and Walter which derived analogous bounds on the $6j$ symbol for the symmetric group S_k [CŞW18]. In that paper, the authors considered the problem of determining whether there exists a density matrix ρ_{ABC} with partial traces $\rho_{AB}, \rho_{BC}, \rho_A, \rho_B$, and ρ_C with a given sextuple of eigenvalues [CŞW18]. Such problems arise naturally in the context of quantum information theory and are typically referred to as quantum marginals problems [CŞW18; Fra22]. In particular, they proved the $6j$ symbols for the symmetric group S_k (referred to as the recoupling coefficients) in the limit as $k \rightarrow \infty$ either decay exponentially or can be bounded from below by a polynomial factor depending on whether there exists a density matrix with the prescribed marginal spectra [CŞW18]. Moreover, they also demonstrated how the tetrahedral Horn problem may be viewed as a special case of the quantum marginals problem and, in a complementary manner, furthermore demonstrated how, by restricting to the subgroup $S_k \subset U(k)$ of permutation matrices and applying Nishiyama's restriction theorem [Nis00], the $6j$ symbols for unitary group $U(n)$ may be viewed as a special case of the $6j$ symbols for the symmetric group S_k [CŞW18]. This latter result obtained by [CŞW18] is a generalizes how the Littlewood-Richardson coefficients can be cast as a special case of the Kronecker coefficients [Lit58; Mur55; IP23]. While the tetrahedral Horn problem may be viewed as a special case of the quantum marginals problem, the approach taken by this paper differs from [CŞW18] as it tackles the tetrahedral Horn problem directly, and consequently, we obtain ??? which provides stronger conditions for tetrahedral eigenvalues which go beyond

the conditions previously obtained in [CŞW18]. We note that this direct approach was initiated, for the $n = 2$ case, by Backens [Bac10].

Multiple Horn problems: More recently, Alekseev et al. have investigated a few variants of the tetrahedral Horn problem and are referred to as *multiple* Horn problems in [Ale+25]. Specifically, Alekseev et al. focus on two variants, the *multiplicative multiple Horn problem* concerning the singular values of products of invertible matrices, and the *tropical multiple Horn problem* concerning singular values of concatenations of weighted planar networks [Ale+25]. The tetrahedral Horn problem we consider here is termed the *additive* multiple Horn problem in the language of [Ale+25].

Other inequalities: It is worth highlighting that there exists related results constraining the eigenvalues of sums of Hermitian matrices which are already readily applicable to the tetrahedral Horn problem. In addition to the aforementioned Horn’s inequalities [Hor62], which constraint the eigenvalues of any triple of Hermitian matrices $(A, B, A + B)$, there exists a myriad of inequalities which constrain the eigenvalues of the quadruple of Hermitian matrices $(Y, X + Y, Y + Z, X + Y + Z)$ whenever $X, Y, Z \geq 0$ are positive semidefinite matrices (see for example [BS15; TCL11; Sag13; BGS08; FG13; LS14; Sra]). These inequalities are readily applicable to the tetrahedral Horn problem under the identification $(X = A, Y = B \text{ and } Z = D)$ wherein they constrain, respectively, the eigenvalues (b, c, e, f) of the matrices (B, C, E, F) while ignoring the eigenvalues of A and D . More scarce are inequalities which additionally incorporate the eigenvalues (a, d) of the matrices (A, D) such as Minkowski-like determinant inequality [NS23, Section 6.2] (originally due to Courtade [Cou16; htt]), or applications of Ptolemy’s inequality [Sch52] or the Cayley-Menger determinant inequality [SJS18, Equation 5.2] to the space of $n \times n$ Hermitian matrices equipped with the Hilbert-Schmit inner product. While each of these previously known inequalities can be viewed as necessary conditions for the tetrahedral Horn problem, to the best of our knowledge, they remain insufficient for the tetrahedral Horn problem when $n \geq 3$. Our contribution, therefore, is to provide a family of necessary and sufficient inequalities in the form of ?? which is applicable to all dimensions n .

Organization of the paper:

TODO

APPENDIX A. SYMMETRIES OF TETRAHEDRAL EIGENVALUES sec: Symmetries

There are numerous types of symmetries present in the statement of the tetrahedral Horn problem. The purpose of this section is to describe the scaling, inversion, tetrahedral, and shifting symmetries of the problem. prop: scaling

Proposition 22 (Scaling). *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and let $s \in (0, \infty)$ be a positive real number. Then the scaled*

eigenvalues, (sa, sb, sc, sd, se, sf) , are tetrahedral if and only if the unscaled eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral.

Proof. The statement follows from the fact that $\text{eig}(sX) = s \text{eig}(X)$ holds for all Hermitian matrices X and positive scalars s and that each of the constraints in Eq. (139) are homogeneous in the six Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) , e.g., we have $sA + sB - sC = 0$ if and only if $A + B - C = 0$ because $s \neq 0$. $\square$

One may wonder whether it is possible to extend the scaling symmetry to negative values for s . Indeed, this can be accomplished, provided one accounts for the fact that negating a Hermitian matrix both negates and reverses the sorting order of its eigenvalues. prop:inversion

Proposition 23 (Inversion). *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues. Given any list of non-increasing eigenvalues $x = (x_1 \geq \dots \geq x_n)$, let x^* denote the inverted list of resorted and negated eigenvalues: $x^* = (-x_n \geq \dots \geq -x_1)$. Then (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral if and only if $(a^*, b^*, c^*, d^*, e^*, f^*)$ are tetrahedral.*

Proof. The statement holds because $\text{eig}(-X) = x^*$ whenever $\text{eig}(X) = x$ and moreover the sextuple of matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfies Eq. (139) if and only if the sextuple of negated matrices $(-A, -B, -C, -D, -E, -F)$ satisfies Eq. (139). $\square$

The inversion symmetry Proposition 23 is just one element belonging to a group of 48 symmetries consisting of inversions of eigenvalues, $x \rightarrow x^*$, or permutations of elements in the sextuple (a, b, c, d, e, f) . prop:tet_symmetry

Proposition 24 (Oriented). *The sextuple (a, b, c, d, e, f) of eigenvalues are tetrahedral if and only if the following sextuples of eigenvalues are tetrahedral:*

{eq:gens_of_tet_sym}

$$(151) \quad (a \ f \ e \ d^* \ c \ b) \quad (c \ e^* \ d^* \ f \ b \ a^*)$$

Moreover, these two operations generate a finite group of order 48 whose action, grouped by conjugacy classes, produces:

{eq:all_of_tet_sym}

$$(152) \quad \begin{array}{l} (a \ b \ c \ d \ e \ f) \\ (d \ b \ f \ a \ e \ c) \\ (d^* \ e \ c \ a^* \ b \ f) \\ (a \ e^* \ f^* \ d \ b^* \ c^*) \\ (b \ f^* \ d^* \ e \ c \ a) \\ (c \ a^* \ b \ f^* \ d^* \ e^*) \\ (e \ c^* \ d \ b \ f \ a^*) \\ (f \ a \ e \ c^* \ d \ b^*) \\ (f^* \ d \ b^* \ c \ a \ e) \\ (e^* \ f \ a^* \ b^* \ c^* \ d) \\ (c^* \ d^* \ e^* \ f \ a^* \ b) \\ (b^* \ c \ a \ e^* \ f^* \ d^*) \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} (a^* \ c \ b \ d \ f \ e) \\ (b^* \ a^* \ c^* \ e \ d \ f) \\ (f^* \ b \ d^* \ c^* \ e^* \ a^*) \\ (e \ d^* \ c \ b^* \ a \ f^*) \\ (c \ b^* \ a \ f \ e \ d) \\ (a \ f \ e \ d^* \ c \ b) \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} (a \ c^* \ b^* \ d^* \ f^* \ e^*) \\ (b \ a \ c \ e^* \ d^* \ f^*) \\ (f \ b^* \ d \ c \ e \ a) \\ (e^* \ d \ c^* \ b \ a^* \ f) \\ (c^* \ b \ a^* \ f^* \ e^* \ d^*) \\ (a^* \ f^* \ e^* \ d \ c^* \ b^*) \end{array} \quad \begin{array}{l} (a^* \ b^* \ c^* \ d^* \ e^* \ f^*) \\ (d^* \ b^* \ f^* \ a^* \ e^* \ c^*) \\ (d \ e^* \ c^* \ a \ b^* \ f^*) \\ (a^* \ e \ f \ d^* \ b \ c) \\ (b^* \ f \ d \ e^* \ c^* \ a^*) \\ (c^* \ a \ b^* \ f \ d \ e) \\ (e^* \ c \ d^* \ b^* \ f^* \ a) \\ (f^* \ a^* \ e^* \ c \ d^* \ b) \\ (f \ d^* \ b \ c^* \ a^* \ e^*) \\ (e \ f^* \ a \ b \ c \ d^*) \\ (c \ d \ e \ f^* \ a \ b^*) \\ (b \ c^* \ a^* \ e \ f \ d) \end{array}$$

Proof. To begin, notice that each of the operations on (a, b, c, d, e, f) appearing in Eq. (151) are invertible (indeed the first operation has order two, while the second operation has order four). The claim that these two operations generate a finite group of order 48 can be checked explicitly using computer software. Now suppose (a, b, c, d, e, f) are the eigenvalues of a sextuple of Hermitian matrices (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfying Eq. (139). Then, for example, the sextuple $(A', B', C', D', E', F') = (A, F, E, -D, C, B)$ (which has the eigenvalues (a, f, e, d^*, c, b)) is also tetrahedral because

$$\begin{aligned} A' + B' - C' &= (A + F - E) = 0, \\ B' + D' - F' &= -(B + D - F) = 0, \\ C' + D' - E' &= -(C + D - E) = 0, \\ A' + F' - E' &= (A + B - C) = 0. \end{aligned} \tag{153}$$

Moreover, as the operation mapping (a, b, c, d, e, f) to (a^*, c, b, d, f, e) is invertible, one also has that if (a, b, c, d, e, f) is not tetrahedral, then neither is (a^*, c, b, d, f, e) . An analogous argument holds for the operation mapping (a, b, c, d, e, f) to (c, e^*, d^*, f, b, a^*) with (A', B', C', D', E', F') given by $(C, -E, -D, F, B, -A)$. $\square$

Remark 25. The group G of order 48 appearing in Proposition 24 corresponds to the subgroup of all possible signed permutations of 6 elements generated by permutations and negations of the elements of the sextuple (A, B, C, D, E, F) which preserves the set of linear constraints in Eq. (139). The group G is isomorphic to both the direct product $S_2 \times S_4$ and to the signed permutation group of three elements, i.e., $(S_2 \times S_2 \times S_2) \rtimes S_3$.

The first isomorphism, $G \simeq S_2 \times S_4$, can be understood as S_2 acting by the inversion of all eigenvalues,

$$(154) \quad (a, b, c, d, e, f) \leftrightarrow (a^*, b^*, c^*, d^*, e^*, f^*),$$

while S_4 acts by permutation of the *vertices* of the tetrahedron in Fig. 2: each vertex permutation induces a permutation of the six directed edges with the possibility of inverting the orientation of a subset of the edges (such edge orientation reversals can be accounted for a corresponding inversion of eigenvalues).

The second isomorphism, $G \simeq (S_2 \times S_2 \times S_2) \rtimes S_3$, can be understood by considering the triplet $(A, D), (B, E), (C, F)$ of non-adjacent pairs of edges in Fig. 2. Accordingly, it is helpful to arrange the sextuple (a, b, c, d, e, f) into a 2×3 grid using the following identification:

$$(155) \quad (a \ b \ c \ d \ e \ f) \cong \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix}.$$

Then one can see that each S_2 factor in the direct product $S_2 \times S_2 \times S_2$ acts faithfully on the sextuple by both negating a certain subset of the columns

and permuting the upper and lower rows leaving just one column unchanged.

$$(156) \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} \leftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} a & e^* & f^* \\ d & b^* & c^* \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} \leftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} d & b & f \\ a & e & c \end{pmatrix}, \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} \leftrightarrow \begin{pmatrix} d^* & e & c \\ a^* & b & f \end{pmatrix}.$$

The symmetric group S_3 of order $3! = 6$ acts instead by permuting the columns and negating a subset of the entries in the top row, producing a subgroup of order 6 of the form:

$$(157) \quad \begin{pmatrix} a & b & c \\ d & e & f \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} b & c^* & a^* \\ e & f & d \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} c^* & a & b^* \\ f & d & e \end{pmatrix} \\ \begin{pmatrix} a^* & c & b \\ d & f & e \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} b^* & a^* & c^* \\ e & d & f \end{pmatrix} \quad \begin{pmatrix} c & b^* & a \\ f & e & d \end{pmatrix}$$

We further remark that these symmetries also corresponding to symmetries of the Wigner $6j$ operator $\left\{ \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\}$ in ?? with the involution $\lambda \mapsto \lambda^*$ corresponding taking the dual representation $V_\lambda^n \mapsto (V_\lambda^n)^*$. In the case where $n = 2$, the involution map becomes the identity map (as every irreducible representation of $SU(2)$ is self-dual, or the reversal of a pair $(x, -x)$ of traceless eigenvalues is trivial), and thus the symmetry group collapses to a group of order $|S_4| = 4! = 24$.

prop:shifting

Proposition 26 (Shifting symmetry). *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and let $x, y, z \in \mathbb{R}$ be fixed. Define shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f})$ by*

$$(158) \quad \begin{aligned} \tilde{a}_i &:= a_i + x, & \tilde{b}_i &:= b_i + y, & \tilde{c}_i &:= c_i + x + y, \\ \tilde{d}_i &:= d_i + z, & \tilde{e}_i &:= e_i + x + y + z, & \tilde{f}_i &:= f_i + y + z. \end{aligned}$$

Then shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f})$ are tetrahedral if and only if the unshifted eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral.

Proof. Given a Hermitian matrix A with eigenvalues $\text{eig}(A) = a$ and a constant $w \in \mathbb{R}$, the eigenvalues of $A + wI$ (where I is the identity matrix) are

$$(159) \quad \text{eig}(A + wI) = (a_1 + w \geq \dots \geq a_n + w).$$

The statement then follows because the sextuple of matrices $(\tilde{A}, \tilde{B}, \tilde{C}, \tilde{D}, \tilde{E}, \tilde{F})$, where

$$(160) \quad \begin{aligned} \tilde{A} &:= A + xI, & \tilde{B} &:= B + yI, & \tilde{C} &:= C + (x + y)I, \\ \tilde{D} &:= D + zI, & \tilde{E} &:= E + (x + y + z)I, & \tilde{F} &:= F + (y + z)I, \end{aligned}$$

have the shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f})$ and satisfy the tetrahedral constraints in Eq. (139) if and only if (A, B, C, D, E, F) satisfy the tetrahedral constraints in Eq. (139). $\square$

As a corollary of the shifting symmetries (Proposition 26) one concludes that to solve the tetrahedral Horn problem, in a certain sense, it suffices

to solve the tetrahedral Horn problem merely for traceless matrices (Corollary 27) or, alternatively, for positive definite or positive semidefinite matrices (Corollary 28).

cor:traceless

Corollary 27 (Traceless eigenvalues). *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues and for any list of n eigenvalues $x = (x_1 \geq \dots \geq x_n)$, let $x^0 := x - \text{Tr}[x]/n$ denote the traceless list of eigenvalues obtained by shifting x by $-\text{Tr}[x]/n$. Then (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral if and only if (i) their traces $(\text{Tr}[a], \text{Tr}[b], \text{Tr}[c], \text{Tr}[d], \text{Tr}[e], \text{Tr}[f])$ are tetrahedral (they satisfy Eq. (146)) and (ii) $(a^0, b^0, c^0, d^0, e^0, f^0)$ are tetrahedral.*

Proof. This “only if” portion of the statement follows from both the tetrahedral trace conditions (Eq. (146)) and applications of the shifting symmetry Proposition 26 with (x, y, z) values

$$(161) \quad x = -n^{-1} \text{Tr}(A), \quad y = -n^{-1} \text{Tr}(B) \quad z = -n^{-1} \text{Tr}(D).$$

The “if” portion of the statement follows from the shifting symmetry applied to the negated (x, y, z) values. $\square$

The next corollary of the shifting symmetry proves that to solve the tetrahedral Horn problem it suffices to solve the tetrahedral Horn problem for non-negative (or positive) eigenvalues only. Indeed, one can simply take the shifting parameters (x, y, z) appearing in Proposition 26 to be sufficiently large. The following corollary establishes, in a certain sense, the minimum shifting required to ensure non-negative (or positive) eigenvalues for all six Hermitian matrices.

cor:psd

Corollary 28 (Non-negativity). *If (a, b, c, d, e, f) are a tetrahedral sextuple of eigenvalues, then necessarily the smallest eigenvalues satisfy*

{eq:min_eig_ineqs}

$$(162) \quad c_n \geq a_n + b_n, \quad f_n \geq b_n + d_n, \quad e_n \geq d_n + c_n, \quad e_n \geq a_n + f_n.$$

Moreover, if (a, b, c, d, e, f) are a sextuple of candidate eigenvalues satisfying Eq. (162), then for any $(x, y, z) \in \mathbb{R}^3$ satisfying

{eq:positive_shift}

$$(163) \quad x \geq -a_n, \quad y \geq -b_n, \quad z \geq -d_n,$$

the resulting shifted eigenvalues $(\tilde{a}, \tilde{b}, \tilde{c}, \tilde{d}, \tilde{e}, \tilde{f})$ (given by Eq. (158)) are all non-negative.

Proof. That tetrahedral eigenvalues satisfy Eq. (162) follows from four applications of the well-known inequality $c_n \geq a_n + b_n$ for the original Horn problem where $C = A + B$ [Bha01]. As a reminder, the smallest eigenvalue x_n of a matrix X is characterized by a minimization: $x_n = \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Xv \rangle$ which produces

(164)

$$c_n = \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Cv \rangle = \min_{\|v\|=1} (\langle v, Av \rangle + \langle v, Bv \rangle) \geq \min_{\|v\|=1} \langle v, Av \rangle + \min_{\|w\|=1} \langle w, Bw \rangle = a_n + b_n.$$

Four applications of this inequality produces Eq. (162). Now if (x, y, z) satisfy Eq. (163), we have for all non-negativity of the shifted eigenvalues,

e.g.,

$$(165) \quad \forall j : \quad \tilde{a}_j = a_j + x \geq a_n + x \geq 0,$$

Similar statements hold for b, c, d, e and f . $\square$

As a consequence of Corollary 28, we will, without loss of generality, henceforth only consider candidate eigenvalues (a, b, c, d, e, d) which are non-negative in the sense that they are associated to positive semidefinite Hermitian matrices.

Remark 29. Although this section listed a handful of symmetries of the tetrahedral Horn problem, there remains the possibility of additional symmetries which are unknown at this time. For example, in the case of 2×2 Hermitian matrices, an additional class of symmetries on the set of edge-lengths (a, b, c, e, d, f) of tetrahedra, known as the *Regge symmetries*, hold [AI19; Boa07; PR68, Theorem 1.1]. If there exists a tetrahedron with edge lengths (a, b, c, d, e, f) , then there also exists a tetrahedron with edge lengths

$$(166) \quad (s_1 - a, s_1 - b, c, s_1 - d, s_1 - e, f) \quad \text{where} \quad s_1 = \frac{a + b + d + e}{2}.$$

Combining this symmetry with the permutational symmetries given by Proposition 24 (noting eigenvalues of traceless 2×2 Hermitian matrices are invariant under negation) one concludes the co-existence of a family of six tetrahedra with edge lengths given by [VMK88, Chapter 9]:

$$(167) \quad \begin{array}{ll} (a, b, c, d, e, f) & (s_1 - a, s_1 - b, c, s_1 - d, s_1 - e, f) \\ (a, s_3 - b, s_3 - c, d, s_3 - e, s_3 - f) & (s_2 - a, b, s_2 - c, s_2 - d, e, s_2 - f) \\ (s_2 - d, s_1 - e, s_3 - f, s_2 - a, s_1 - b, s_3 - c) & (s_1 - d, s_3 - e, s_2 - f, s_1 - a, s_3 - b, s_2 - c) \end{array}$$

where

$$(168) \quad s_1 = \frac{a + b + d + e}{2}, \quad s_2 = \frac{a + c + d + f}{2}, \quad s_3 = \frac{b + c + e + f}{2}.$$

Remark 30. The Regge symmetry of a tetrahedron can be understood as a consequence of an earlier discovery of a surprising symmetry of Wigner $6j$ symbol for $SU(2)$ originally due to Regge [Reg59]. The paper due to Boalch provides a comprehensive and modern treatment of the Regge symmetry for the $6j$ symbol for $SU(2)$ by viewing it as a consequence of a symmetry of multiplicity-free $6j$ -symbols for $SU(3)$ [Boa07]. That the Regge symmetry of a tetrahedron emerges from the Regge symmetry of the associated $6j$ symbols can be viewed as a consequence of the semiclassical limit of the latter [PR68; Rob99]. It has also been shown that the Regge symmetry of Euclidean tetrahedra is actually a scissors-congruence preserving both the volume and Dehn invariants [AI19]. At the moment, it remains unclear if analogous symmetries for the generalized Wigner $6j$ symbol exist for $n \geq 3$ (although there are conjectured symmetries for the $6j$ symbols for $U_q(\mathfrak{sl}_n)$ which would follow from the eigenvalue hypothesis [MS18; LS23]). It could

also be possible for additional symmetries to be present in the tetrahedral Horn problem for $n \geq 3$ which are *not* present in the $6j$ symbol for $U(n)$.

APPENDIX B. RESULTS FOR THE ORIGINAL HORN PROBLEM sec:new_inq_horn_orig

The purpose of this section is to describe how our methods can also be used to prove the following result which pertains to the original Horn problem. thm:tri_iff

Theorem 31. *Let $(a, b, c) \in (\mathbb{R}_+^n)^3$ be a triple satisfying the trace conditions. Then $(a, b, c) \in \text{Horn}^+(n)$ if and only if for all pairs of positive weights $(\alpha, \beta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^2$ the following inequality is satisfied*

$$(169) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a) \varphi_\beta(b) \leq \sum_{\substack{\gamma \\ c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma > 0}} \varphi_\gamma(c).$$

Furthermore, if these inequalities are satisfied for all pairs $(\alpha, \beta) \in (\Lambda_{++}^*)^2$ with $|\alpha| + |\beta| = k$, then

$$(170) \quad \frac{D(a, b; c)}{\text{Tr}[c]} \leq O\left(n \sqrt{\frac{\log k}{k}}\right).$$

where $D(a, b; c) := \min_{(A, B) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b} \|\text{eig}(A + B) - c\|_1$.

The proof of this theorem is divided into two parts. First we prove the necessity of Eq. (169) in Appendix B.1. Then afterwards we prove the distance bound in Eq. (170) which in turn implies the sufficiency of Eq. (169) upon taking the limit as $k \rightarrow \infty$. sec:tri_necess

B.1. Necessary conditions. The following proposition follows directly from the binomial theorem (??) and pertains to sums of the quantity $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$. prop:disummation

Proposition 32. *Let X, Y be $n \times n$ matrices. Then the following identities hold:*

$$(171) \quad \forall \alpha, \beta : \quad \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) = \varphi_\alpha(X) \varphi_\beta(Y),$$

$$(172) \quad \forall \gamma : \quad \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) = \varphi_\gamma(X + Y).$$

Proof. The first identity involving a summation over α and β is simply the result of taking the trace of both sides of ??. For the second identity, involving a summation over γ , follows from the resolution of the identity

$$(173) \quad \sum_{\gamma \vdash |\alpha| + |\beta|} \Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma = \text{id}_{V_\alpha^n \otimes V_\beta^n} :$$

$$\varphi_\alpha(X) \varphi_\beta(Y) = \text{Tr}[\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y)] = \sum_{\gamma} \text{Tr}[\Pi_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma (\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y))] = \sum_{\gamma} \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y),$$

where the last equality is just the definition of $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$. Once again, the condition that $|\gamma| = |\alpha| + |\beta|$ is implicitly present. $\square$

Remark 33. One might consider what happens to the operator $\Phi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ when one sums over γ instead of (α, β) . However, an analogous identity concerning a sum over γ of the operator $\Phi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ does not immediately follow because the tensor product $\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y)$ is not necessarily block diagonalizable into γ -isotypic subspaces in any obvious way. One exception occurs when $X = Y$, in which case,

$$(174) \quad \pi_\alpha(X) \otimes \pi_\beta(X) = \sum_{\gamma} \iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} (\pi_{\gamma}(X) \otimes \text{id}_{C_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}}) \iota_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma;\dagger},$$

which is the operator version of the character product formula $\chi_\alpha(X)\chi_\beta(X) = \sum_{\gamma} c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \chi_{\gamma}(X)$.

Under the assumption that the matrices X and Y are positive semidefinite, we can conclude that the real number $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y)$ is also non-negative because $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) = \text{Tr}[\Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}(\Phi_\alpha(X) \otimes \Phi_\beta(Y))]$ where $\Pi_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}$ is a projection operator and $\Phi_\alpha(X), \Phi_\beta(Y) \geq 0$ because $X, Y \geq 0$. Moreover, we note that $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) = 0$ whenever the Littlewood-Richardson coefficient $c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma}$ vanishes. These observations imply the following necessary condition for compatibility of eigenvalues for the original Horn problem.

prop:coupling_condition

Proposition 34. *Let (a, b, c) be a triple of non-negative eigenvalues. Then there exists positive semidefinite $n \times n$ matrices (A, B, C) satisfying $A + B = C$ with eigenvalues (a, b, c) only if for every triple of Young diagrams (α, β, γ) there exists a non-negative $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \geq 0$ such that $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = 0$ whenever $c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = 0$ and*

$$(175) \quad \forall \alpha, \beta : \quad \sum_{\gamma} \Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b), \quad \text{and} \quad \forall \gamma : \quad \sum_{\alpha, \beta} \Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = \varphi_{\gamma}(c).$$

Proof. The claim follows directly from Proposition 32 after identifying $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} = \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(A, B) \geq 0$. $\square$

cor:row_col_horn_ineqs

Corollary 35. *Let (a, b, c) be the eigenvalues of positive semidefinite $n \times n$ matrices (A, B, C) satisfying $A + B = C$. Then,*

$$(176) \quad \forall \alpha, \beta : \quad \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b) \leq \sum_{\substack{\gamma \\ c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} > 0}} \varphi_{\gamma}(c), \quad \text{and} \quad \forall \gamma : \quad \varphi_{\gamma}(c) \leq \sum_{\substack{\alpha, \beta \\ c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} > 0}} \varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b).$$

Proof. The claim follows from Proposition 34 and noting that whenever $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} > 0$ (only when $c_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} > 0$) we have the bound $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^{\gamma} \leq \min\{\varphi_{\alpha}(a)\varphi_{\beta}(b), \varphi_{\gamma}(c)\}$ for all triples (α, β, γ) . $\square$

Remark 36. Using Proposition 34, it is possible to prove even stronger inequalities than those appearing in Corollary 35 by examining the set of triples of Young diagrams (α, β, γ) where $c_{\alpha, \beta}^{\gamma} \neq 0$. We illustrate this point

with an example. Let $k = |\alpha| + |\beta| = |\gamma| = 4$, then the following is the table of values for $c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$.

$c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma$	α						β													
	1	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0
	0	1	0	0	0	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	1	0	0	0
	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	0
	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	0	0	1	0
	0	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	0	0	1

Using this table, one sees the inequalities in Corollary 35 are associated to single columns or single rows, e.g., along the $(\alpha, \beta) = (\boxplus, \boxplus)$, we obtain

$$(177) \quad \varphi_{\square}(X)\varphi_{\square}(Y) \leq \varphi_{\square\square}(X+Y) + \varphi_{\square\square}(X+Y).$$

However, using Proposition 34, a stronger inequality is obtained by including all columns covered by the rows associated to the right-hand side of the above inequality, e.g.,

$$(178) \quad \varphi_{\boxplus}(X) + \varphi_{\boxminus}(X) + \varphi_{\boxtimes}(X)\varphi_{\boxtimes}(Y) + \varphi_{\boxtimes}(X)\varphi_{\boxtimes}(Y) + \varphi_{\boxtimes}(Y) + \varphi_{\boxtimes}(Y) \leq \varphi_{\boxplus}(X+Y) + \varphi_{\boxminus}(X+Y).$$

In general, Proposition 34 describes a linear system of inequality constraints in the variables $\Gamma_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma, \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$, and $\varphi_\gamma(c)$ which, in principle, be solved for $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$ and $\varphi_\gamma(c)$ by standard linear quantifier elimination techniques such as Fourier-Motzkin elimination [DE+72]. While these additional inequalities are certainly interesting to explore, Theorem 31 establishes that for the purposes of resolving the original Horn problem, it is sufficient to restrict our attention to inequalities of the form Corollary 35.

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sec:dist_bound_for_orig_horn
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B.2. Distance bound & sufficiency. Here we prove the distance bound stated in Theorem 31. To begin we fix an *arbitrary* pair (α, β) with total size $|\alpha| + |\beta| = k$ and derive multiple bounds on the product $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$. Afterwards, we will sum over all such pairs and then obtain the claimed bound on $D(a, b; c)$.

First we bound $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$ in two ways and then apply the eigenvalue separation lemma (specifically Eq. (84)). The first bound on $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$ is obtained from relaxing Eq. (169) by considering a Young diagram γ^* of size k which maximizes $\varphi_{\gamma^*}(c)$ among those γ such that $c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma > 0$ for the given (a, b, c) . As there are at most $(k+1)^{n-1}$ Young diagrams of size k , we conclude

$$\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b) \leq (k+1)^{n-1}\varphi_{\gamma^*}(c).$$

The second bound on $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$ is obtained by considering ?? which states that for any γ such that $c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma > 0$,

$$(180) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b) = \frac{\dim V_\alpha^n \otimes V_\beta^n}{c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \dim V_\gamma^n} \mathbb{E}_{(X,Y) \sim \mathcal{O}_x \times \mathcal{O}_y} \varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y).$$

To relax this into a usable bound we (i) bound the dimensions by $\frac{\dim V_\alpha^n \otimes V_\beta^n}{c_{\alpha\beta}^\gamma \dim V_\gamma^n} \leq \dim(V_\alpha^n \otimes V_\beta^n) \leq (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}}$, then (ii) bound the average over $X \in \mathcal{O}_x$ and $Y \in \mathcal{O}_y$ with a maximum, then (iii) apply Corollary 35 to get $\varphi_\gamma^{\alpha\beta}(X, Y) \leq \varphi_\gamma(X+Y)$ and then finally (iv) specialize to the optimal $\gamma \mapsto \gamma^*$ to produce

{eq:second_ab_bound}

$$(181) \quad \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b) \leq (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}} \max_{(X,Y) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b} \varphi_{\gamma^*}(X+Y).$$

Then we combine the two bounds on $\varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b)$ from Eq. (179) and Eq. (181) and apply the eigenvalue separation bound Eq. (84) to obtain

(182)

$$(183) \quad \begin{aligned} \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b) &\leq \sqrt{(k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}}(k+1)^{n-1} \max_{(X,Y) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b} \varphi_{\gamma^*}(X+Y)\varphi_{\gamma^*}(c)}, \\ &\leq \sqrt{(k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2}}(k+1)^{n-1}(k+1)^{\binom{n}{2}} \max_{(X,Y) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b} \frac{\text{BC}(\text{eig}(X+Y), c)^k}{k!}}, \end{aligned}$$

{eq:ab_intermediate_bound}

$$(184) \quad = (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2} + \frac{n-1}{2}} \frac{\text{BC}(a, b; c)^k}{k!},$$

where $\text{BC}(a, b; c)$ is defined as the maximum Bhattacharyya coefficient

$$(185) \quad \text{BC}(a, b; c) := \max_{(X,Y) \in \mathcal{O}_a \times \mathcal{O}_b} \text{BC}(\text{eig}(X+Y), c).$$

Now we sum both sides of Eq. (184) over *all* pairs (α, β) with total size $|\alpha| + |\beta| = k$ to obtain

$$(186) \quad \frac{\text{Tr}[c]^k}{k!} \leq (k+1)^{2\binom{n}{2} + \frac{n-1}{2} + 2n} \frac{\text{BC}(a, b; c)^k}{k!},$$

where the left-hand side follows from the trace condition $\text{Tr}[c] = \text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b]$ and

{eq:binomial_trace}

$$(187) \quad \sum_{\ell=0}^k \sum_{\substack{\alpha \vdash \ell \\ \beta \vdash k-\ell}} \varphi_\alpha(a)\varphi_\beta(b) = \sum_{\ell=0}^k \frac{\text{Tr}[a]^\ell}{\ell!} \frac{\text{Tr}[b]^{k-\ell}}{(k-\ell)!} = \frac{(\text{Tr}[a] + \text{Tr}[b])^k}{k!},$$

whereas the extra factor of $2n$ in the exponent on the right-hand side is obtained because there are at most $(k+1)^n$ Young diagrams with n rows

and size at most k and we are summing over a pair (α, β) with total size $|\alpha| + |\beta| = k$. This establishes a lower bound on $\text{BC}(a, b; c)$ of the form

$$(188) \quad \frac{\text{BC}(a, b; c)}{\text{Tr}[c]} \geq \left(\frac{1}{(k+1)^{\frac{2n^2+3n-1}{2}}} \right)^{\frac{1}{k}}$$

Finally, using ??, we substitute the maximum normalized Bhattacharyya coefficient $\frac{\text{BC}(a, b; c)}{\text{Tr}[c]}$ with a minimum normalized distance to obtain Eq. (170) which completes the proof.

APPENDIX C. THE LARGE n LIMIT & AN ENTROPIC INEQUALITY sec:large_n

The purpose of this section is to show how to leverage the inverse polynomial bound on $\left\| \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\|$ for tetrahedral (a, b, c, d, e, f) provided by Corollary 21 to derive inequalities on the entropies of the eigenvalues. Our strategy will be to prove an upper bound on the $6j$ symbol which depends only on the dimensions of the underlying irreducible representations and the multiplicity spaces between them. By combining this upper bound with the lower bound provided by Corollary 21 (specifically the n -independent bound in Eq. (15)), we will prove the following. thm:entropic_ineq

Theorem 37. *Let (a, b, c, d, e, f) be tetrahedral eigenvalues. Then* eq:entropic_ineq

$$(189) \quad s(c) + s(f) - s(b) - s(e) \geq 0,$$

where

$$(190) \quad s(x) := - \sum_{i=1}^n x_i \log x_i. \quad \text{eq:little_s_defn}$$

We begin with our upper bound on the $6j$ symbol. lem:sixj_ssa_bound

Lemma 38. *Let $(\alpha, \beta, \gamma, \delta, \epsilon, \phi)$ be a sextuple of Young diagrams. Then*

$$(191) \quad \left\| \begin{smallmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{smallmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq \left(c_{\alpha, \phi}^{\epsilon} c_{\beta, \delta}^{\phi} c_{\alpha, \beta}^{\gamma} c_{\gamma, \delta}^{\epsilon} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{\dim(V_{\gamma}^n) \dim(V_{\phi}^n)}{\dim(V_{\beta}^n) \dim(V_{\epsilon}^n)}.$$

Proof. Here we provide a diagrammatic proof of the claimed inequality. For the sake of clarity, we abbreviate the irreducible representation labels, V_{λ}^n , and omit the multiplicity space labels on the intermediate steps.

$$(192) \quad \begin{array}{c} \text{Diagrammatic proof of Lemma 38} \end{array}$$

The diagrammatic proof shows the inequality between two expressions. The left side is a product of two $6j$ symbols, each represented by a box containing a 3×3 grid of Young diagrams. The right side is a product of two $6j$ symbols, each represented by a box containing a 3×3 grid of Young diagrams, followed by a fraction of the product of dimensions of the irreducible representations.

The first equality follows from ???. The inequality follows from an application of the Cauchy-Schwarz inequality with respect to the annotated contraction. The final equality follows from applying Schur's lemma to components of the diagram mapping V_β^n to itself on the left and V_ϵ^n to itself on the right. Note that the factors of $\dim(V_\epsilon^n)^2$ appearing on left-most and right-most sides of the above inequality cancel producing the claimed inequality. $\square$

An immediate application of Lemma 38 is to combine it with Eq. (15). If (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral eigenvalues, then by Corollary 21 there exists a converging sequence of Young diagrams $(\alpha_k, \beta_k, \gamma_k, \delta_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ such that

$$\frac{1}{q(k)} \leq \left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha_k & \beta_k & \gamma_k \\ \delta_k & \epsilon_k & \phi_k \end{Bmatrix} \right\|_2^2 \leq \left(c_{\alpha_k, \phi_k}^{\epsilon_k} c_{\beta_k, \delta_k}^{\phi_k} c_{\alpha_k, \beta_k}^{\gamma_k} c_{\gamma_k, \delta_k}^{\epsilon_k} \right)^{\frac{1}{2}} \frac{\dim(V_{\gamma_k}^n) \dim(V_{\phi_k}^n)}{\dim(V_{\beta_k}^n) \dim(V_{\epsilon_k}^n)}.$$

where $q(k)$ is some polynomial in k independent of the dimension n (see Eq. (15)). Remarkably, the Littlewood-Richardson coefficients $c_{\alpha_k, \phi_k}^{\epsilon_k}, c_{\beta_k, \delta_k}^{\phi_k}, c_{\alpha_k, \beta_k}^{\gamma_k}$ and $c_{\gamma_k, \delta_k}^{\epsilon_k}$ are also *independent* of the dimension parameter n defining the group $U(n)$ (assuming n is at least as large as the maximum depth of any of the involved Young diagrams. This observation provides us with an opportunity to optimize the above bound by varying the value of n .

In particular, it will be useful to better understand how the dimension, $\dim(V_\lambda^n)$, of the irreducible representation V_λ^n of $U(n)$ grows as n becomes much larger than the number of rows of λ . In general, for fixed λ , the function $n \mapsto V_\lambda^n$ can grow at an exponential rate with increasing n . One can find estimates for $\dim(V_\lambda^n)$ in the regime where n is large compared to $|\lambda|$ and also the last row $\lambda_{\min}$ is large compared to the depth of λ in paper by Itzykson and Nauenberg [IN66, Section III]. Here we use an elegant presentation of this scaling, which relates the asymptotics of $\dim(V_\lambda^n)$ to the value of $\dim(W_\lambda)$ (see [Har23, Lemma 2] or [CHW07, Equations (25, 26)]).

Proposition 39. *Let λ be a Young diagram with depth at most n . Then*

$$(194) \quad \frac{\dim(V_\lambda^n)}{n^{|\lambda|}} = \frac{\dim(W_\lambda)}{|\lambda|!} \prod_{(i,j) \in \lambda} \left(1 + \frac{j-i}{n} \right).$$

Proof. The statement follows from comparing the the Weyl dimension formula for $\dim(V_\lambda^n)$ given in Eq. (195) with the Frobenius dimension formula for $\dim(W_\lambda)$ given in [GW00, Corollaries 9.1.5]:

$$(195) \quad \dim(W_\lambda) = \frac{|\lambda|! \Delta(\lambda + \rho)}{\prod_{i=1}^n (\lambda + \rho)_i!}.$$

That this formula for $\dim(W_\lambda)$ does not depend on n for $n \geq \ell(\lambda)$ and coincides with the Hook-length formula given earlier is proved by [GW00, Corollary 9.1.6]. For additional details, see also [Har23, Appendix A]. $\square$

From Proposition 39 we obtain the following corollary.

cor:harrow_ssa_lim

Corollary 40. *Let $\gamma, \phi, \beta, \epsilon$ be a quadruple of Young diagrams such that*

$$(196) \quad |\gamma| + |\phi| = |\beta| + |\epsilon|.$$

Then

$$(197) \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\dim(V_\gamma^n) \dim(V_\phi^n)}{\dim(V_\beta^n) \dim(V_\epsilon^n)} = \frac{|\beta|! |\epsilon|! \dim(W_\gamma) \dim(W_\phi)}{|\gamma|! |\phi|! \dim(W_\beta) \dim(W_\epsilon)} = \frac{H_\beta H_\epsilon}{H_\gamma H_\phi}$$

Proof. From Proposition 39 one evidently has for any Young diagram λ the limit

$$(198) \quad \lim_{n \rightarrow \infty} \frac{\dim(V_\lambda^n)}{n^{|\lambda|}} = \frac{\dim(W_\lambda)}{|\lambda|!} = \frac{1}{H_\lambda}$$

where H_λ is the product of the hook lengths in λ as defined by Eq. (34). The claim then follows because the missing prefactor, $\frac{n^{|\beta|} n^{|\epsilon|}}{n^{|\gamma|} n^{|\phi|}}$, is equal to one by Eq. (196). $\square$

We are now in a position to prove the main result of this section.

Proof of Theorem 37. As (a, b, c, d, e, f) are tetrahedral, the inverse polynomial bound on $\left\| \begin{Bmatrix} \alpha & \beta & \gamma \\ \delta & \epsilon & \phi \end{Bmatrix} \right\|$ for tetrahedral (a, b, c, d, e, f) provided by Corollary 21 implies it must at least be non-zero and thus Eq. (196) holds. Therefore, by Corollary 40 and the discussion surrounding the bound in Eq. (193) we conclude that along the convergent sequence of Young diagrams,

$$(199) \quad \lim_{k \rightarrow \infty} \frac{1}{k} \log \left(\frac{H_{\beta_k} H_{\epsilon_k}}{H_{\gamma_k} H_{\phi_k}} \right) \geq 0$$

provided the limit. To prove the limit exists, an application of Stirling's approximation, $\log n! \approx n \log n - n$ [Rob55], to the approximation formula $H_\lambda \approx \prod_{i=1}^n \lambda_i!$ produces for any constant η the formula

$$(200) \quad \frac{1}{\eta} \log H_\lambda \approx (\log \eta - 1) |\lambda| + \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\lambda_i}{\eta} \log \frac{\lambda_i}{\eta}$$

Because $|\gamma| + |\phi| = |\beta| + |\epsilon|$ (Eq. (196)), the $(\log \eta - 1)$ terms will cancel in Eq. (199). Then using the fact that that $(\beta_k, \gamma_k, \epsilon_k, \phi_k)$ converge in proportion to the eigenvalues (b, c, e, f) (with proportionality constant $\eta = \frac{k}{\text{Tr}[e]}$), we conclude that Eq. (199) has a limit and moreover it equals the left-hand side of Eq. (189). $\square$

*{eq:balanced_sizes}**{eq:hook_ratio_limit}*